

Current Affairs MCQs PDF - March, 2026



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1. What is 'VSHORADS', recently seen in the news?

- [A] Man Portable Air Defence System (MANPAD)
- [B] Peacekeeping operations in Europe
- [C] Mobile Short Range Air Defence System
- [D] Military exercise between India and Europe

Answer: Man Portable Air Defence System (MANPAD)

Defence Research and Development Organisation successfully conducted three consecutive flight trials of the Very Short-Range Air Defence System (VSHORADS) at Integrated Test Range, Chandipur off the coast of Odisha. VSHORADS stands for Very Short-Range Air Defence System and it is a Man Portable Air Defence System (MANPADS). It is indigenously designed and developed by Research Centre Imarat under DRDO with other laboratories and production partners. It is a lightweight, short-range, surface-to-air missile used to destroy aircraft and helicopters. Maximum range is 8 kilometres and it can engage targets up to 4.5 kilometres altitude.

2. The Amondawa tribe is primarily found in which country?

- [A] Brazil
- [B] Kenya
- [C] India
- [D] Egypt

Answer: Brazil

The Amondawa tribe lives deep inside the Amazon rainforest of Brazil. Researchers found that they live without clocks, calendars, or counting numerical age. Their language has no words for time, week, month, or year. They describe events in sequence but do not treat time as an abstract concept. They do not track birthdays or calculate age in numbers. Life stages are marked through identity and name changes. As a person grows, they receive new names at different stages. Their society is organised around natural cycles and social identity, not numerical time.

3. Nilgiri Wood Pigeon, that was recently seen in news, is endemic to which region?

- [A] Ladakh
- [B] Chotanagpur plateau
- [C] Western Ghats
- [D] Eastern Ghats

Answer: Western Ghats

A recent study warns that climate change may restrict the habitat of the Nilgiri Wood Pigeon to a few isolated pockets in the Western Ghats by the end of the century. It is an



endemic pigeon species of the Western Ghats in India. It is large, dark in colour, with a distinctive checkerboard pattern on its nape. It lives in high-elevation wet evergreen, moist evergreen, semi-evergreen forests and shola forests. It is mainly found in the Nilgiris and Anamalai Hills, with isolated populations in Biligirirangan Hills, Nandi Hills and northern Maharashtra.

4. Light Combat Helicopter (LCH) Prachand has been developed by which organization?

- [A] Bharat Dynamics Limited
- [B] Defence Research and Development Organisation
- [C] Indian Space Research Organisation
- [D] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited

Answer: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited

Recently, the President of India undertook a sortie in the indigenous Light Combat Helicopter (LCH) Prachand at Air Force Station Jaisalmer, Rajasthan. It is an indigenously developed Light Combat Helicopter made by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited. It is the only attack helicopter in the world capable of landing and taking off at 5,000 metres (16,400 feet). It has advanced stealth features, armoured protection and night attack capability. It has crash-resistant landing gear for better survivability. It reduces radar and Infrared (IR) signature and has a countermeasure dispensing system against enemy missiles.

5. A new groundwater fish species, Gitchak nakana, has been discovered in which northeastern state?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Manipur
- [C] Mizoram
- [D] Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: Assam

A new groundwater fish species, Gitchak nakana, has been discovered in Assam. It belongs to a newly described genus under the family Cobitidae (loaches). The name comes from the Garo language: "Gitchak" means red, referring to its blood-red colour, and "na-tok" and "kana" mean blind fish. It shows subterranean adaptations like absence of visible eyes, translucent pigmentless body, and extreme miniaturisation. It completely lacks a skull roof, with the brain covered only by skin. It lives in groundwater aquifers, which are difficult to access.

6. Where was India's first Semiconductor Assembly, Test and Packaging (ATMP) facility inaugurated?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Gujarat

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated India's first Semiconductor Assembly, Test and Packaging (ATMP) facility at Sanand, Gujarat. The plant is set up by Micron Technology



India with an investment of over ₹22,500 crore. It marks the start of commercial production and shipment of made-in-India semiconductor memory modules. The project is approved under the India Semiconductor Mission.

7. Which cricket team won Ranji Trophy title 2025-26?

- [A] Jammu and Kashmir
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Saurashtra

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

Jammu and Kashmir cricket team won its maiden Ranji Trophy title by defeating Karnataka cricket team at KSCA Rajnagar Stadium. J&K scored 584 in the first innings, while Karnataka managed 293. With this win, J&K joined teams like Vidarbha, Saurashtra, Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh in recent title winners, showing wider growth of Indian domestic cricket.

8. Sulawesi Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Indonesia
- [B] China
- [C] Maldives
- [D] Japan

Answer: Indonesia

A 67,800-year-old hand stencil found in a limestone cave on Sulawesi is now the oldest known rock art in the world. Sulawesi, earlier called Celebes, is a large island in Southeast Asia and part of the Greater Sunda Islands of Indonesia. Makassar is its largest city. It is surrounded by Borneo (west), the Philippines (north), Maluku Islands (east), and Flores and Timor (south). The island is mountainous with some active volcanoes; its highest peak is Ratenkombola (Mario).

9. Zero Discrimination Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] March 1
- [B] March 2
- [C] March 3
- [D] March 4

Answer: March 1

Zero Discrimination Day is observed annually on 1st March. It is organised by the United Nations. The day promotes global solidarity to end all forms of discrimination. It encourages inclusion, compassion, peace, and positive social change. The observance educates people on equality and the importance of respecting human rights for everyone.

10. The Villages of Excellence is an initiative between India and which country?

- [A] Indonesia
- [B] Israel
- [C] Japan
- [D] Russia

**Answer: Israel**

Villages of Excellence was announced by the Prime Minister Narendra Modi during his state visit to Israel in February 2026. The Villages of Excellence is a collaborative initiative between India and Israel aimed at enhancing agricultural productivity and farmer income. It aims to bring Israeli agricultural technology from centralized research centers directly to villages, increasing productivity and income for lakhs of Indian farmers.

11. Tomahawk cruise missile has been developed by which country?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Israel
- [C] United States
- [D] Ukraine

Answer: United States

The United States carried out strikes on Iranian targets using advanced weapons, including Tomahawk cruise missiles, stealth fighter jets, B-2 bombers, and low-cost one-way attack drones. Tomahawk is an United States of American (USA)-made long-range subsonic cruise missile used for deep land attack. It is launched from ships or submarines through a Vertical Launch System. It was first developed in the 1970s during the Cold War. It can carry a 1,000-pound conventional warhead or cluster munitions. It uses solid propellant at launch and later a turbofan engine, reducing infrared detection.

12. Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary, which recently hosted the Indian Bison Fest, is located in which state?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Odisha

Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary hosted the second edition of the two-day Indian Bison Fest. It is located in Bargarh district of Odisha near Hirakud Dam on the Mahanadi River. Hirakud Dam is the longest dam in India and the longest earthen dam in the world. The sanctuary is linked with freedom fighter Veer Surendra Sai, whose base at Barapathara was here during revolt against British rule.

13. The MAVEN (Mars Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution) mission was launched by which space agency?

- [A] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- [B] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [C] Canadian Space Agency (CSA)
- [D] European Space Agency (ESA)

Answer: National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

Researchers detected a lightning-like “whistler” radio signal in the Martian ionosphere, first evidence of such electromagnetic activity on Mars. Detection was made using data from Mars Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution (MAVEN) mission. The MAVEN (Mars



Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution) mission was launched by the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA). It is the first spacecraft dedicated to studying the Martian upper atmosphere to understand how the planet lost its atmosphere and water over time.

14. Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) functions under which nodal ministry?

- [A] Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- [B] Ministry of Power
- [C] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [D] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer: Ministry of Power

The 25th Foundation Day of the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), Ministry of Power, was celebrated in New Delhi. BEE is a statutory body established in 2002 under the Energy Conservation Act, 2001. The objective is to reduce energy intensity in the Indian economy. It coordinates with designated consumers, agencies, and organizations; uses existing resources to implement the Energy Conservation Act. Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) functions under Ministry of Power

15. Persian Gulf, that was recently seen in news, is located in which ocean?

- [A] Pacific Ocean
- [B] Atlantic Ocean
- [C] Indian Ocean
- [D] Arctic Ocean

Answer: Indian Ocean

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has issued an urgent advisory to all Indian carriers to avoid flying through the West Asian and Persian Gulf airspace due to rising military tensions. The Persian Gulf is a marginal sea of the Indian Ocean located in Western Asia. It is an extension of the Gulf of Oman and connects to the Indian Ocean through the Strait of Hormuz in the east. The Persian Gulf is also known as the Arabian Gulf or Gulf of Iran.

16. Which state government launched the country's first integrated Divyang Sahayak Portal?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Maharashtra

Maharashtra government launched the country's first integrated Divyang Sahayak Portal to streamline welfare schemes for persons with disabilities and improve implementation of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016. Portal reduces procedural steps, eliminates manual paperwork, and addresses data inaccuracies and grievance redressal issues. citizens can search for schemes without remembering names based on demographic data and apply online. Entire departmental processing is digital, with service level agreements and auto-forward mechanism for pending applications.



17. Which city launched the 'Saksham Skill Survey', the first initiative of its kind in India?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: Mumbai

Mumbai's suburban district launched the 'Saksham Skill Survey', the first initiative of its kind in India, to assess the skills of youth aged 18–40 and enhance employability. The survey will cover 55,000 households in the H-West ward of Mumbai. Conducted door-to-door using AI, it will collect data on educational qualifications, skill interests, and training needs for employment. It is based on survey results, candidates will be provided a list of government-approved institutions and relevant courses. The aim is to train at least 15,000 candidates by next year and make 5,000 self-reliant through employment or entrepreneurship.

18. Which Indian state recorded the highest GST growth of 37% during FY 2025–26 (up to December 2025)?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Sikkim
- [C] Nagaland
- [D] Manipur

Answer: Nagaland

Nagaland recorded the highest Goods and Services Tax growth in India at 37 percent, above the national average of 6.8 percent till December 2025. The achievement was announced by Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla during the Budget Session of the Nagaland Assembly. Goods and Services Tax collections reached ₹987.38 crore by 31 January 2026. This exceeded the 2025–26 target of ₹949 crore. The figures show strong revenue performance and robust financial growth in the State.

19. The ASMITA League is part of which flagship sports programme of the Government of India?

- [A] Target Olympic Podium Scheme
- [B] Fit India Movement
- [C] Rajiv Gandhi Khel Abhiyan
- [D] Khelo India Mission

Answer: Khelo India Mission

In March 2026, Union Minister of State Raksha Nikhil Khadse from the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports announced a special nationwide Achieving Sports Milestone by Inspiring Women Through Action League to celebrate International Women's Day on March 8. The league started in 2021 and has conducted over 2,600 events in 34 sports across 550 districts and 700 cities, involving more than 3 lakh women athletes. It is part of the Khelo India Mission to promote gender equality and identify grassroots talent. It is supported by Sports Authority of India, State and District Sports Associations, Khelo India Centres, My Bharat, and National Centres of Excellence.



20. Who is the author of the book "Mahatma: A Great Communicator" released in March 2026?

- [A] Ramachandra Guha
- [B] Dhiraj Kakadia
- [C] Rajmohan Gandhi
- [D] Bibek Debroy

Answer: Dhiraj Kakadia

In March 2026, Union Minister Mansukh Mandaviya of the Ministry of Labour and Employment and Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports released the book "Mahatma: A Great Communicator" at Gandhi Darshan, Rajghat, New Delhi. The book is written by Dr Dhiraj Kakadia, Additional Director General of Akashvani. It highlights the life of Mahatma Gandhi and focuses on how his powerful communication skills strengthened India's freedom struggle. The aim is to spread awareness and inspire people to follow his values in daily life.

21. The Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) functions under which Ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Commerce & Industry
- [B] Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare
- [C] Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution
- [D] Ministry of Rural Development

Answer: Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution

Union Minister Pralhad Joshi inaugurated the 70th Foundation Day of Central Warehousing Corporation on 2 March 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. Central Warehousing Corporation is a Central Public Sector Enterprise under Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution and supports food security, storage and logistics. In Financial Year 2024-25, it recorded highest turnover ₹2,776.88 crore and Profit Before Tax ₹711.60 crore, higher than Financial Year 2023-24. It proposed ₹160.10 crore dividend and aims for higher growth in Financial Year 2025-26 through digital and infrastructure expansion.

22. GI-tagged Karbi Anglong Ginger, that was recently seen in news, is associated with which state?

- [A] Nagaland
- [B] Mizoram
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Assam

Answer: Assam

Assam flagged off its first trial export of 1.2 metric tonnes of Geographical Indication tagged Karbi Anglong Ginger to London, marking a major agricultural milestone. Karbi Anglong district produces this premium ginger variety known for strong aroma, high pungency and medicinal value. It is grown mainly in Singhasan Hills using traditional Jhum shifting cultivation and Tila farming methods. It has Geographical Indication tag, confirming its unique origin and quality. It has high essential oil content, strong earthy flavour and digestive and anti inflammatory benefits. It is widely demanded in culinary,



pharmaceutical and processing industries.

23. Attukal Pongala is mainly celebrated in which state?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Kerala

Attukal Pongala is celebrated on 3 March at Attukal Bhagavathy Temple. Attukal Pongala is celebrated in Kerala. It is one of the largest gatherings of women in the world and entered Guinness World Records in 2009 with over 2.5 million participants. The festival honours Goddess Attukal Bhagavathy, incarnation of Kannaki, symbolising women power and devotion. The 10 day festival begins with Kappukettu ritual and ends with priests blessing the offering and sprinkling holy water.

24. The "Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Yatra Scheme" has been launched by which state/UT government?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Puducherry

Answer: Puducherry

The first batch under the Dr B R Ambedkar Yatra Scheme of Puducherry Government started their journey to visit places linked with B. R. Ambedkar. The yatra was flagged off at Puducherry Railway Station by Lieutenant Governor K Kailashnathan. The "Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Yatra Scheme" has been launched by the Government of Puducherry. The scheme is implemented by the Adi Dravidar and Scheduled Tribes Welfare Department of Puducherry. The government is spending ₹40,000 per beneficiary for the yatra. The aim is to spread awareness about Dr Ambedkar's life and legacy and improve the scheme through participant feedback.

25. Hatti Risala festival is primarily celebrated in which state?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Maharashtra

The historic Hatti Risala procession in Jalna celebrated its 138th year on Dhulivandan, the day after Holi. The Hatti Risala festival is primarily celebrated in Maharashtra. The festival is a specific, historic, and cherished cultural tradition held annually in the city of Jalna in Maharashtra. It is celebrated on the occasion of Dhulivandan (the day following Holi). A decorated elephant carries a symbolic king and prime minister who shower sweets called revdis on the crowd.

26. Which city is the venue of Bharat Steel 2026 Summit?

- [A] New Delhi



- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: New Delhi

India will host Bharat Steel 2026 in New Delhi from 16 April 2026 as a two day global summit. It will bring together leaders from steel, technology, mining and trading sectors to discuss the next generation steel ecosystem. The summit will act as a platform for policy and business dialogue to shape the future of the steel industry. It aims to promote sustainable industrial growth. The event will showcase India's strength in the steel sector and enhance its global position.

27. What is the IUCN conservation status of 'Ruddy Shelduck' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Least Concern

Residents of Mudh village in Ladakh have protected the Ruddy Shelduck for over 20 years by safely escorting fledglings to the Indus River during breeding season. Ruddy Shelduck, also called Brahminy duck, is a large migratory water bird found in Europe, Central Asia and Africa, and winters in South Asia. In India, Ladakh is its only breeding site, nesting in high altitude wetlands from June to August. It lives in rivers, lakes, marshes, ponds and reservoirs from sea level up to 4,800 metres. It is listed as Least Concern by International Union for Conservation of Nature.

28. National Safety Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] March 1
- [B] March 2
- [C] March 3
- [D] March 4

Answer: March 4

National Safety Day is observed every year on 4 March in India to promote accident prevention and safety culture. In 2026, India marks the 55th National Safety Week with theme "Engage, Educate and Empower People to Enhance Safety". The campaign is led by National Safety Council, established on 4 March 1966. National Safety Day was first celebrated in 1972 to spread awareness on workplace safety and occupational health. Now it is expanded as National Safety Day and National Safety Month with workshops, drills and awareness drives. The year 2026 highlights nearly six decades of efforts in safety, health and environmental protection.

29. Which state/UT is the host of National Governance Conference 2026?

- [A] Jammu and Kashmir
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan



[D] Delhi

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances with Government of Jammu and Kashmir organised the National Governance Conference on 3 March 2026 in Jammu. The conference was held in Jammu city of Jammu and Kashmir. The theme was “Holistic Development of Districts: Transforming Governance for Viksit Bharat”. It focused on improving district level governance and strengthening administration at grassroots level. The event highlighted innovative governance models and best practices from different districts across India.

30. Hudson River, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

[A] Australia

[B] France

[C] United States

[D] United Kingdom

Answer: United States

A Cessna 172 aircraft crashed into the Hudson River near the Newburgh–Beacon Bridge, bringing focus to the river corridor. Hudson River is a major and historically important river in the United States. It flows mainly within New York State and forms part of the boundary between New York and New Jersey in its final stretch. It connects inland New York to the Atlantic Ocean through Upper New York Bay. It originates in the Adirondack Mountains near Mount Marcy, with Lake Tear of the Clouds as its main headstream source.

31. 'Green Choupal' (or Green Chaupal) initiative was launched by which state government?

[A] Uttar Pradesh

[B] Gujarat

[C] Rajasthan

[D] Karnataka

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

The Yogi Adityanath-led Uttar Pradesh government is working to make the state a 'green state' through large scale sapling plantations. The 'Green Choupal' initiative engages public participation in more than 15,000 villages through monthly Gram Sabha meetings led by Gram Pradhans. It was launched by Uttar Pradesh government. Over the past nine years, more than 242 crore saplings have been planted, increasing forest cover by 559.19 sq km according to India State of Forest Report 2023.

32. A wild banana *Musa sikkimensis*, that was recently seen in news, is native to which region?

[A] Eastern Himalayas and Northeast India

[B] Eastern Ghats

[C] Chotanagpur plateau

[D] Western Ghats

Answer: Eastern Himalayas and Northeast India

Researchers at Nagaland University studied the genetic diversity of *Musa sikkimensis*, a



wild banana native to the Eastern Himalayas and Northeast India. Known as Darjeeling or Sikkim banana, it is a wild seeded species with traits for disease resistance, environmental stress tolerance, and climate adaptability, crucial for future breeding. Though not widely cultivated for fruit, it strengthens crop resilience, food security, and sustainable agriculture. Nagaland, part of the Indo Burma biodiversity hotspot, hosts diverse indigenous banana genotypes at risk due to deforestation and human activity.

33. Which state has become the first country in the United Kingdom to allow water cremation, also called hydrolysis?

- [A] Ireland
- [B] England
- [C] Scotland
- [D] Wales

Answer: Scotland

Scotland became the first country in the United Kingdom to allow water cremation, also called hydrolysis. The new rules were approved by the Scottish Parliament, marking the biggest funeral law reform since 1902. Hydrolysis uses water and potassium hydroxide at about 150 degree Celsius to break down soft tissues, leaving only bones, which are dried and turned into ashes. In 2023 public consultation, 84 percent supported hydrolysis. The method is already legal in 28 United States states and countries like Canada, Ireland, Australia and New Zealand.

34. Shtil missile is developed by which country?

- [A] Russia
- [B] Israel
- [C] China
- [D] India

Answer: Russia

The Ministry of Defence signed contracts worth Rs 5,083 crore for defence acquisitions. Procurement includes six Advanced Light Helicopters (ALH) Mk-III in Maritime Role for the Indian Coast Guard. Contracts also cover Surface-to-Air Vertical Launch (SAM) Shtil missiles for the Indian Navy. Shtil missile is a medium-range, ship-based, vertical-launch surface-to-air missile system developed by Russia. It primarily uses the 9M317ME semi-active radar homing (SARH) missile.

35. Which state government launched Project HANUMAN to address human-wildlife conflict?

- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Jharkhand

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

Andhra Pradesh government launched Project HANUMAN to address human-wildlife conflict. HANUMAN stands for Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife. The initiative aims to rescue, treat, rehabilitate, and monitor injured



wildlife, strengthening conservation and rapid response systems. Human-wildlife conflict in Andhra Pradesh is rising: 2,107 cases recorded in 2025-2026, with nearly Rs 4 crore paid as compensation.

36. Which state government launched the fifth edition of the herSTART programme for women entrepreneurs in March 2026?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Rajasthan
- [C] Bihar
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Gujarat

Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel launched the fifth edition of the herSTART programme for women entrepreneurs at Gujarat University. The university's convention centre was named Vidyagauri Nilkanth Sabhapuram in honor of Vidyagauri Nilkanth, the first Gujarati woman graduate. The state government is committed to women-led development, following the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The herSTART programme, run by the Gujarat University Startup and Entrepreneurship Council, provides incubation, mentorship, and market access support to women-led startups.

37. Which day is observed as International Day for Disarmament and Non-Proliferation Awareness?

- [A] March 2
- [B] March 3
- [C] March 4
- [D] March 5

Answer: March 5

The United Nations observes International Day for Disarmament and Non-Proliferation Awareness on March 5 to promote understanding of disarmament, especially among young people. Multilateral disarmament and arms limitation have been central to UN efforts to maintain international peace and security. Weapons of mass destruction, particularly nuclear weapons, remain a primary concern due to their destructive power and threat to humanity. Excessive conventional weapons accumulation and illicit trade in small arms endanger peace, security, and development.

38. According to the World Obesity Atlas 2026, which country had the highest number of children with obesity in 2025?

- [A] Nepal
- [B] Russia
- [C] India
- [D] China

Answer: China

According to the World Obesity Atlas 2026, nearly 15 million children aged 5–9 and over 26 million children aged 10–19 in India were overweight or obese in 2025. The World Obesity Federation warned that the 2025 global target to halve childhood obesity rise will be



missed; the deadline is now extended to 2030, but most countries, including India, remain off track. India ranks second to China, with 41 million children with high BMI and 14 million living with obesity. China leads with 62 million high BMI and 33 million obesity, while the USA has 27 million high BMI and 13 million obesity.

39. Where was the inaugural edition of the Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative (SDI) held in March 2026?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

The inaugural edition of the Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative (SDI) was held on 5 March 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. It was organised as part of the Raisina Dialogue. The initiative was jointly launched by Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India and Observer Research Foundation (ORF). It aims to create a global platform focused on the growing role of science and technology in international diplomacy and policy-making.

40. Which institution has launched the “moonshot project” to develop brain co-processors?

- [A] Indian Institute of Science
- [B] Indian Institute of Technology Delhi
- [C] Indian Institute of Technology Madras
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Indian Institute of Science

The Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru, has launched a “moonshot” research project to develop brain co-processors, which will combine neuromorphic hardware and artificial intelligence algorithms to enhance or restore human brain functions. The initiative is financially supported by the Pratiksha Trust. The project aims to develop both implantable and non-invasive brain co-processors capable of decoding neural signals from brain recordings, processing these signals using AI algorithms, and sending them back to the brain through neural stimulation or neurofeedback.

41. Cassava Brown Streak Disease, that was recently seen in news, was first identified in which region?

- [A] Africa
- [B] Europe
- [C] South America
- [D] Australia

Answer: Africa

A recent study has warned that more than one-third of Africa is at risk of the spread of Cassava Brown Streak Disease (CBSD), which is a highly destructive disease affecting cassava crops. CBSD is considered one of the most devastating diseases of cassava, as it severely reduces both the production and quality of cassava tubers (roots), which are an



important staple food in many African countries. The disease was first identified in the mid-20th century in the coastal regions of East Africa, and since then it has spread significantly across the African continent.

42. Which organization has deployed the AI system 'Sudarshan' to monitor misleading financial content on digital platforms in March 2026?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India
- [B] Securities and Exchange Board of India
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India

Answer: Securities and Exchange Board of India

In March 2026, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) deployed an in-house Artificial Intelligence (AI) system named "Sudarshan" to strengthen the digital monitoring of financial content across online platforms. The primary objective of the Sudarshan AI system is to detect misleading financial information and curb illegal advisory activities carried out by unregistered financial influencers (finfluencers) on digital platforms. Using this AI-based surveillance system, SEBI has facilitated the removal of more than 1.20 lakh misleading social media posts that were shared by unregistered individuals or entities providing financial advice.

43. Golestan Palace, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Israel
- [C] Russia
- [D] Saudi Arabia

Answer: Iran

Golestan Palace, located in Tehran, Iran, is a historic royal complex and one of the oldest monuments in the capital city. The palace recently sustained damage due to shockwaves and debris from airstrikes conducted by the United States and Israel, highlighting risks to cultural heritage during conflicts. It served as the official residence and seat of power of the Qajar Dynasty, which ruled Iran from 1789 to 1925.

44. Which country has become the first in the Americas to be officially verified for the elimination of leprosy?

- [A] Brazil
- [B] Mexico
- [C] Chile
- [D] Peru

Answer: Chile

The World Health Organization (WHO) and the Pan American Health Organization (PAHO) have officially verified that Chile has eliminated Leprosy, also known as Hansen's disease. With this achievement, Chile has become the first country in the Americas and the second country globally to be officially verified as having eliminated the disease. Leprosy was first recorded in Chile in the late 19th century, primarily on Rapa Nui (also known as Easter



Island). The disease remained largely confined to the island, while mainland Chile experienced only occasional sporadic cases.

45. Glyptothorax sentimereni and Oreichthys elianae, that were recently seen in news, belongs to which species?

- [A] Fish
- [B] Spider
- [C] Ant
- [D] Snake

Answer: Fish

Researchers from Northeast India have described two new freshwater fish species from Nagaland. The species are named Glyptothorax sentimereni and Oreichthys elianae. They were discovered during ichthyological surveys in tributaries of the Brahmaputra River in Mokokchung district, Nagaland. Glyptothorax sentimereni was found in rocky stretches of the Dikhu River and belongs to torrent-dwelling catfishes. Oreichthys elianae was found in a tributary of the Tsurang River.

46. Recently, a pair of Dusky Eagle Owls was spotted in which state after 15 years?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Himachal Pradesh
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Uttarakhand

A pair of rare dusky eagle owls was sighted in the Phato tourism zone of Terai West forest division, near Corbett Tiger Reserve, Uttarakhand, after 15 years. The dusky eagle owl belongs to the family Strigidae. It is large, greyish-brown with prominent ear tufts, greyish-white underparts with dark streaks, and dark brown wings with whitish streaks. It is found in Pakistan, India, Nepal, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Thailand, Malaysia, and China. It inhabits thick riverside forests and old-growth trees.

47. According to recent study, which two countries have the highest absolute metabolic disease burdens in the Asia-Pacific region?

- [A] India and Japan
- [B] China and India
- [C] Thailand and India
- [D] China and Japan

Answer: China and India

India and China have the highest absolute metabolic disease burdens in the Asia-Pacific region, according to the Global Burden of Disease, Injuries, and Risk Factors Study (GBD) 1990–2023, with forecasts up to 2030. The peer-reviewed study in Metabolism analyzed disability-adjusted life years (DALYs) and mortality for Type 2 diabetes mellitus, high systolic blood pressure (BP), high body mass index (BMI), high LDL cholesterol, and metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease (MASLD). In 2023, India recorded approx 21 million DALYs and 5.8 lakh deaths from Type 2 diabetes, and 3.8 crore DALYs



with 15.7 lakh deaths from high systolic BP.

48. SWAYATT – Startups, Women and Youth Advantage through e-Transactions is an initiative of which platform?

- [A] Make in India
- [B] Startup India
- [C] Government e-Marketplace (GeM)
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Government e-Marketplace (GeM)

Government e-Marketplace (GeM) celebrated seven years of its SWAYATT initiative – Startups, Women and Youth Advantage through e-Transactions. SWAYATT initiative was launched on 19 February 2019 by Government e-Marketplace (GeM). SWAYATT aims to make public procurement more inclusive for startups, women entrepreneurs, youth, Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs), Self Help Groups (SHGs), and last-mile sellers. The initiative addresses three key challenges: access to markets, access to finance, and access to value addition. It enables enterprises to connect directly with government buyers through GeM's digital procurement platform.

49. Which ministry is the central nodal agency for MPLADS–eSAKSHI portal?

- [A] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

The MPLADS–eSAKSHI web portal was launched on 1 April 2023 to manage the revised fund-flow procedure under the Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS). The Central Nodal Agency for the portal is the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI). The portal makes MPs' annual entitlement available online at the start of each financial year or tenure. MPs use the portal to recommend developmental works and earmark funds; District Authorities sanction works and assign Implementing Agencies. Recent improvements include a revamped public dashboard showing works recommended, sanctioned, completed, and expenditure with drill-down tabs.

50. IMPAct4Nutrition (I4N) is an initiative of which organization?

- [A] World Health Organization (WHO)
- [B] United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) India
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Answer: United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) India

NITI Aayog signed a Statement of Intent (SOI) with UNICEF India to support strategic interventions in Aspirational Districts and Blocks. The agreement aims to leverage both institutions' strengths to improve maternal and child nutrition in underserved areas. UNICEF India, via IMPAct4Nutrition (I4N), will provide technical expertise and engage



businesses, public sector enterprises, and industry associations to channel Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) investments into nutrition-focused initiatives. IMPAct4Nutrition (I4N) is primarily an initiative of UNICEF India.

51. India's first lighthouse on an inland waterway is being constructed on which river?

- [A] Ganga
- [B] Yamuna
- [C] Brahmaputra
- [D] Godavari

Answer: Brahmaputra

Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal laid the foundation stones for four riverine lighthouses along the Brahmaputra River, the first such lighthouses on an inland waterway in India. The lighthouses will be constructed at Bogibeel, Pandu, Silghat, and Biswanath Ghat along National Waterway-2, with a total investment of ₹84 crore. The project aims to strengthen inland waterways as a sustainable, cost-efficient transport mode, reducing carbon emissions compared to road transport.

52. Which state is the host of Khelo India Tribal Games (KITG) 2026?

- [A] Jharkhand
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Bihar
- [D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Chhattisgarh

The inaugural Khelo India Tribal Games (KITG) 2026 will be held from March 25 to April 6 across Raipur, Jagdalpur, and Sarguja in Chhattisgarh. The Games will feature seven medal sports: athletics, football, hockey, weightlifting, archery, swimming, and wrestling; mallakhamb and kabaddi will be demonstration sports. The logo, theme song, and mascot 'Morveer' were unveiled on December 23, 2025; 'Morveer' combines 'Mor' (mine/our own) and 'Veer' (courage/valour), reflecting tribal pride.

53. What is the theme of International Women's Day 2026?

- [A] Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls
- [B] Give to Gain
- [C] Embrace Equity
- [D] Invest in women: Accelerate progress

Answer: Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls

8 March 2026 marks International Women's Day, celebrated globally to honour women's achievements and push for gender equality. The United Nations theme for 2026 is "Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls." The focus is on addressing legal gaps worldwide, as women currently hold only about 64% of the legal rights that men have globally. The campaign aims to move beyond "rights on paper" to ensure laws are enforced in daily life. In India, the focus includes women's safety, equal pay, and improved access to justice in both rural and urban areas.

54. Which financial institution has launched specialised 'Spoorthi' programme for women



entrepreneurs?

- [A] L&T Finance Ltd
- [B] HDFC Ltd
- [C] HDFC Ltd
- [D] ICICI Bank

Answer: L&T Finance Ltd

L&T Finance Ltd has launched a specialised programme called “Spoorthi” for women entrepreneurs to provide targeted financial support. The programme offers extended loan tenors up to 25 years for house property loans or Loan Against Property (LAP) for business expansion and working capital. Industrial LAP tenors of up to 12 years are also available, with enhanced eligibility norms, including higher debt-to-income ratios for greater financial flexibility. L&T Finance aims to leverage women borrowers’ strong repayment discipline to scale businesses and secure personal assets, promoting an inclusive financial ecosystem.

55. World Engineering Day is celebrated on which day every year to recognize engineering's role in sustainable development?

- [A] March 1
- [B] March 2
- [C] March 3
- [D] March 4

Answer: March 4

World Engineering Day (WED) is celebrated on 4 March every year to recognise engineering’s role in sustainable development. UNESCO officially recognises the day, and it is delivered globally by the World Federation of Engineering Organizations (WFEO). The Adani Group has been named as an official partner for WED 2026, marking the first time an Indian organisation has been selected by WFEO for this global recognition. The theme for WED 2026 is “Smart engineering for a sustainable future through innovation and digitalisation.”

56. Minuteman III is an intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) developed by which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] Russia
- [C] China
- [D] Israel

Answer: United States

The United States conducted a test launch of the Minuteman III missile. Minuteman III is an intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) developed by United States. It is part of the US nuclear triad. It is a land-based nuclear missile under the US Air Force Global Strike Command. The missile uses three solid-propellant rocket motors and can reach speeds of about Mach 23 at burnout. It has a range of over 6,000 miles (5,218 nautical miles), enabling long-distance nuclear strike capability.

57. The Precision Strike Missile (PrSM) is developed by which country?



- [A] United States
- [B] Iran
- [C] Israel
- [D] China

Answer: United States

The Precision Strike Missile (PrSM) was recently used by the United States for the first time in operations by United States Central Command during the conflict with Iran. It is a surface-to-surface guided ballistic missile designed to strike long-distance targets with very high precision. The missile is developed mainly for the United States Army by Lockheed Martin, a major US aerospace and defence company. It has an open system architecture and modular design, allowing upgrades and integration with new technologies.

58. The Low Temperature Thermal Desalination (LTTD) programme has been implemented by which organization?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organisation
- [B] National Institute of Ocean Technology
- [C] Council of Scientific and Industrial Research
- [D] Defence Research and Development Organisation

Answer: National Institute of Ocean Technology

The Union Minister for Earth Sciences recently visited the Low Temperature Thermal Desalination (LTTD) plant at Kavaratti in Lakshadweep to review desalination facilities. Low Temperature Thermal Desalination (LTTD) is a technology that converts seawater into drinking water by using temperature differences in ocean water. The project is implemented by National Institute of Ocean Technology under the Ministry of Earth Sciences. LTTD plants operate on eight Lakshadweep islands including Kavaratti, Minicoy, Agatti and Kalpeni, improving year-round drinking water supply.

59. Mumps disease, that was recently seen in news, is caused by which agent?

- [A] Bacteria
- [B] Virus
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Protozoa

Answer: Virus

Health officials in Maryland, United States recently reported an increase in mumps cases and issued a health alert. Mumps is a contagious viral disease caused by the mumps virus, which belongs to the paramyxovirus group. The disease mainly causes painful swelling of the parotid salivary glands (parotitis) near the ears and jaw. Humans are the only host, and the virus spreads through respiratory droplets from sneezing, coughing, or contact with infected saliva. There is no specific treatment, and medicines mainly relieve symptoms.

60. A two new species of fruit flies named *Acidoxantha paratotoflava* and *Hemilea suneriae* has been discovered in which state?



- [A] Uttar Pradesh
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Uttarakhand
- [D] Himachal Pradesh

Answer: Himachal Pradesh

Entomologists discovered two new species of fruit flies named *Acidoxantha paratotoflava* and *Hemilea suneriae* in the Himalayan foothills of Solan district in Himachal Pradesh. *Acidoxantha paratotoflava* is a medium-sized greenish-yellow fly with four black stripes on its thorax and large black spots on its abdomen. The species also has distinct hook-like structures in the male anatomy, which help in identification. *Hemilea suneriae* is a reddish-brown fruit fly with prominent black dots on its body. It has a unique wing pattern with a single clear “window” (hyaline indentation) in a dark wing area, unlike related species that usually have two. The discovery adds to India’s insect biodiversity and improves scientific knowledge of fruit fly taxonomy.

61. The Blue Sparrow missile is developed by which country?

- [A] Israel
- [B] Russia
- [C] Iran
- [D] United States

Answer: Israel

Recently, Israel reportedly used the Blue Sparrow missile in a strike in Tehran, targeting Ali Khamenei, the Supreme Leader of Iran. The Blue Sparrow missile is part of an air-launched ballistic missile family that also includes the Black Sparrow missile and Silver Sparrow missile. It is developed by Rafael Advanced Defense Systems, an Israeli defence technology company. The missiles were originally designed as target missiles for testing the Arrow missile defence system of Israel. Later, the Blue Sparrow was modified into an offensive air-to-surface missile. It is about 6.5 metres long and weighs around 1.9 tonnes. The missile is usually launched from fighter aircraft such as F-15 jets, which boost it to high altitude.

62. Solomon Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which ocean?

- [A] Arctic Ocean
- [B] Indian Ocean
- [C] Atlantic Ocean
- [D] Pacific Ocean

Answer: Pacific Ocean

Recently, a 6.7-magnitude earthquake struck Kirakira in the Solomon Islands. It is located in the south-western Pacific Ocean. The Solomon Islands lie southeast of Papua New Guinea and northwest of Vanuatu. The country consists of two parallel chains of volcanic islands and small coral atolls. It includes about 1,000 islands, with 6 large main islands and more than 900 smaller ones, of which around 147 are inhabited. The capital city, Honiara, is located on Guadalcanal, the largest island.



63. Where was 9th International Santal Conference held?

- [A] West Bengal
- [B] Jharkhand
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Kerala

Answer: West Bengal

The 9th International Santal Conference was held in Darjeeling, West Bengal on 7 March 2026. The conference focused on preservation of Santal language, culture, traditions and tribal heritage while encouraging social and economic development. It highlighted the historic struggles of the Santal community against exploitation, including the Santal Hul uprising of 1855. The event also recalled that the Santali language was included in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution of India in 2003. It recognised the Ol Chiki script, invented in 1925, which helped strengthen Santali literature and cultural expression.

64. "Jal Mahotsav 2026" is organised by which department?

- [A] Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation
- [B] Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- [C] Department of Food and Public Distribution
- [D] Department of Water Resources, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation

Answer: Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation

The Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS) under the Ministry of Jal Shakti organised Jal Mahotsav 2026 from 8 March to 22 March, linking International Women's Day and World Water Day. The campaign supports community participation in rural drinking water management under the Jal Jeevan Mission. It is launched from Navsari in Gujarat with Jal Arpan ceremonies across India, symbolising the handover of water supply schemes to Gram Panchayats and Village Water and Sanitation Committees (VWSCs). The campaign aims to strengthen Jan Bhagidari (people's participation) and community ownership of rural piped water systems.

65. What is "Deinococcus radiodurans" that was recently mentioned in news?

- [A] Bacteria
- [B] Virus
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Invasive weed

Answer: Bacteria

Researchers found that *Deinococcus radiodurans* can survive extremely high pressures of 14,000–24,000 Earth atmospheres, similar to pressures during planetary impacts. It is a bacterium famous for its extreme resistance to ionizing radiation, earning the nickname "Conan the Bacterium." The organism is gram-positive, non-motile, and reddish in colour. It was first discovered in 1956 in radiation-treated canned meat. It can survive radiation doses thousands of times higher than those fatal to humans, making it one of the most radiation-resistant organisms on Earth.

66. Which state government has released a Draft Population Management Policy in March 2026?



- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Tamil Nadu

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

The Government of Andhra Pradesh has released a Draft Population Management Policy to address declining fertility rates and future demographic challenges. The policy aims to increase the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) from 1.5 to the replacement level of 2.1, encouraging families to have a third child through financial and social incentives. Total Fertility Rate (TFR) indicates the average number of children a woman is expected to have in her lifetime; 2.1 is considered necessary to maintain a stable population. The policy proposes a “Poshana – Shiksha – Suraksha” incentive package.

67. Which state/UT hosted the National Conference of Women Thinkers on the theme ‘Bharati – Nari Se Narayani’?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Delhi
- [C] Uttarakhand
- [D] Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: Delhi

Delhi hosted the National Conference of Women Thinkers on the theme ‘Bharati – Nari Se Narayani’. The conference highlighted that national progress is reflected in women’s advancement, education, and empowerment. It emphasized that women are both carriers of tradition and agents of societal change, and their empowerment is a collective societal responsibility. Initiatives have been launched to make women economically, socially, and professionally self-reliant, including schemes like ‘Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana’ and ‘Saheli Pink Smart Card’. Women’s power is recognized as an emerging force of national strength.

68. Which state government launched the “Stand with Her” campaign to establish the state as the safest for women?

- [A] Telangana
- [B] Haryana
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Telangana

Telangana launched the “Stand with Her” campaign to establish the state as the safest for women. The campaign encourages youth to act as brand ambassadors for women’s safety. It emphasizes that true protection comes from social responsibility, not only from legislation. The initiative promotes a collective fight against gender discrimination.

69. What is the IUCN status of ‘Sambar deer’ that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Least Concern



[D] Vulnerable

Answer: Vulnerable

The Wildlife Wing of the Himachal Pradesh Forest Department recently recorded sambar deer in high-altitude protected areas of Chamba district using camera traps for the first time. Sambar deer is a large deer species native to the Indian subcontinent, southern China and Southeast Asia. It is naturally found in India, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Myanmar, the Philippines, China, Taiwan, Borneo, Malaysia, Sumatra and Java. The species lives mainly in forested hills, thick forests, swamp forests and open scrublands, often near cultivated areas. According to the International Union for Conservation of Nature Red List, its conservation status is Vulnerable.

70. Where was Mobile World Congress (MWC) 2026 held?

[A] Paris, France

[B] New Delhi, India

[C] Geneva, Switzerland

[D] Barcelona, Spain

Answer: Barcelona, Spain

Mobile World Congress (MWC) 2026 was held from 2–5 March 2026 at Barcelona, Spain. It is the world's largest event for the mobile and technology industry. The theme for 2026 is "The IQ Era". The event focused on integrating Artificial Intelligence (AI) with advanced connectivity for smarter networks, digital innovation, and societal transformation. The event was organised by the Global System for Mobile Communications Association (GSMA). Indian telecom innovators showcased their technologies and innovations at the global platform.

71. Human Metapneumovirus (HMPV) has recently spread rapidly across the West Coast of which country?

[A] Canada

[B] United States

[C] Australia

[D] United Kingdom

Answer: United States

Human Metapneumovirus (HMPV) is a highly contagious respiratory virus spreading rapidly on the West Coast of the United States (US). It belongs to the Pneumoviridae family, which also includes Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV). It mainly causes common cold-like respiratory illness. The virus spreads through air via coughing and sneezing, close personal contact, and touching contaminated surfaces then touching face. Common symptoms include cough, fever, nasal congestion, and shortness of breath. In severe cases, it may lead to bronchitis or pneumonia. No vaccine or specific antiviral treatment; care focuses on symptom management and preventing complications.

72. *Stenothoe lowryi* is a rare shrimp-like marine crustacean recently recorded in which Indian state?

[A] Odisha



- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Odisha

Stenothoe lowryi is a rare shrimp-like marine crustacean recently recorded in India for the first time. It was discovered at Arjyapalli Beach by researchers from Berhampur University, Odisha. Earlier, the species was known only from Malaysia waters. It belongs to family Stenothoidae under the order Amphipoda. Amphipods are small invertebrate crustaceans related to crabs, lobsters, and shrimp. They live in oceans, lakes, rivers, beaches, caves, and moist tropical habitats. The name Amphipoda means “different-footed” because they have different types of legs.

73. The Proba-3 Mission is launched by which space agency?

- [A] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- [B] Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)
- [C] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [D] European Space Agency (ESA)

Answer: European Space Agency (ESA)

Proba-3 recently made news after European Space Agency lost contact with one of its two spacecraft. It is European Space Agency's first mission focused on precision formation flying, where two satellites operate in extremely accurate coordination. The mission aims to create an artificial solar eclipse to study the Sun's outer atmosphere (corona). This helps scientists observe the faint solar corona, which is normally hidden by the Sun's intense brightness. The mission includes two small satellites: a Coronagraph spacecraft and an Occulter spacecraft shaped like the solar disc.

74. Kharg Island, that was recently seen in news, is a small coral island located in which country?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Russia
- [C] Israel
- [D] China

Answer: Iran

Kharg Island is a small coral island in Iran in the northern Persian Gulf, recently discussed in United States strategic debates. It is one of the few Persian Gulf islands with natural freshwater, stored in porous limestone formations. The island has hot, humid summers and its highest point is Mount Didehban. In the early 1960s, discovery of offshore oil fields led to major petroleum and petrochemical infrastructure development. Its strategic importance comes from its location near the Strait of Hormuz, a vital global oil shipping route.

75. The National Climate Stack Innovation Challenge has been launched by which organization?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- [B] National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
- [C] Asian Development Bank (ADB)



[D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD), with Gates Foundation and Dalberg Advisors, launched the National Climate Stack Innovation Challenge to strengthen India's rural climate resilience. The initiative aims to build a National Climate Stack, integrating fragmented climate datasets into a unified digital platform. It will develop 10–15 year climate hazard forecasting frameworks for risks like heatwaves, floods, droughts, and cyclones affecting agriculture. The project will also create practical dashboards for agriculture, rural finance, and public planning decisions.

76. India's first fully operational 'Ring Metro' was inaugurated in which city?

[A] Mumbai

[B] Delhi

[C] Bengaluru

[D] Hyderabad

Answer: Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated two new Delhi Metro corridors, including India's first fully operational 'Ring Metro', improving public transport in the capital. The first corridor, Majlis Park–Maujpur Babarpur on the Pink Line, is 12.3 km long with eight elevated stations and forms part of the Majlis Park–Shiv Vihar Pink Line, extending it to 71.56 km. The second corridor, Deepali Chowk–Majlis Park on the Magenta Line, is 9.9 km long with seven elevated stations, raising the line length to 49 km; parts reach 28.36 metres height, among the highest in Delhi Metro.

77. Which state government launched the Cyber Safety Protocol 2026 to protect students in public schools from cyber threats?

[A] Tamil Nadu

[B] Karnataka

[C] Maharashtra

[D] Kerala

Answer: Kerala

Kerala Infrastructure and Technology for Education launched the Cyber Safety Protocol 2026 to protect students in public schools from cyber threats, especially those from Artificial Intelligence (AI). The protocol aligns with IT Act 2000, Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act 2023, POCSO Act, and 2026 IT rule amendments on Synthetically Generated Information (SGI). It identifies 20 major cyber threats, including deepfakes, AI grooming, and digital arrest, and provides prevention and reporting guidance.

78. Lamitiye 2026 is the joint military exercise conducted between India and which country?

[A] Seychelles

[B] Russia

[C] Australia

[D] Egypt

Answer: Seychelles



An Indian Armed Forces contingent arrived in Seychelles for the 11th edition of “Lamitiye 2026”, a joint military exercise with the Seychelles Defence Forces, held from March 9 to March 20 at the Seychelles Defence Academy. “Lamitiye”, meaning “friendship” in Creole, is a biennial exercise conducted since 2001 in Seychelles. All three Indian Armed Forces services are participating: Army (Assam Regiment), Navy (INS Trikand), and Air Force (C-130 aircraft). The 12-day exercise includes joint tactical drills, field training, combat discussions, case studies, lectures, and demonstrations, ending with a two-day validation exercise.

79. Which organisation released the first Annual Report on the National Highways Green Cover Index (NH-GCI) 2025–26?

- [A] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [B] National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)
- [C] Forest Survey of India
- [D] Centre for Science and Environment (CSE)

Answer: National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)

National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) released the first Annual Report on the National Highways Green Cover Index (NH-GCI) 2025–26 to quantitatively assess plantations along National Highways. The report was prepared with National Remote Sensing Centre (NRSC), Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) using space-based high-resolution satellite sensors to measure chlorophyll content and vegetation presence. NH-GCI represents the percentage of land covered by green cover within the Right of Way (RoW) along highways at a 1 km granularity.

80. As per recent data, what is India’s global rank as a destination for cross-border capital into land and development sites?

- [A] First
- [B] Second
- [C] Third
- [D] Fourth

Answer: Fourth

As per recent data, real estate investments in nine major Asia-Pacific (APAC) markets reached USD 71.9 billion in H1 2025, marking a 6% decline year-on-year due to global trade volatility and economic headwinds. The APAC markets covered include Australia, Mainland China, Hong Kong, India, Japan, Singapore, South Korea, New Zealand, and Taiwan. India ranked fourth globally for cross-border real estate investment, with USD 3 billion invested in H1 2025, reflecting a 15% decline from H1 2024, but investor interest remained strong. Foreign investments in India were USD 1.6 billion (52%), while domestic capital was USD 1.44 billion (48%), rising 53% year-on-year.

81. The SHINE app was launched by which organization to promote workplace safety and empowerment for women employees?

- [A] Ministry of Labour & Employment
- [B] NITI Aayog



[C] Indian Railways

[D] Ministry of Women and Child Development

Answer: Indian Railways

The Indian Railways recently launched the SHINE app on International Women's Day to promote workplace safety and empowerment for women employees. SHINE stands for Sexual Harassment Incident Notification for Empowerment. The app allows women employees to lodge complaints of sexual harassment while maintaining confidentiality. Complaints are addressed promptly by the Internal Complaints Committee in accordance with Visakha Guidelines (1997) and government instructions. Complaints can be filed through the Human Resources Management System (HRMS) and the Employee Self Service portal.

82. Orunodoi (Arunodoi) Scheme was launched by which state government?

[A] Assam

[B] Manipur

[C] Mizoram

[D] Tripura

Answer: Assam

The Assam Chief Minister announced a transfer of ₹9,000 to about 40 lakh beneficiary families under the Orunodoi scheme via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT). Orunodoi (Arunodoi) Scheme, launched in 2020, aims at women empowerment, poverty alleviation, and socio-economic inclusion of financially vulnerable women in Assam. The scheme provides financial support of ₹1,250 per month to women from low-income families through DBT. The monthly amount covers essential expenses: ₹400 for medicines, ₹200 for pulses subsidy, ₹80 for sugar subsidy, ₹150 for fruits & vegetables, ₹150 for other essentials, ₹170 for COVID-19 expenses, and ₹250 for 50 units of electricity.

83. The Anavaran Deforestation Alert System is operated by which organisation?

[A] Indian Space Research Organisation

[B] Forest Survey of India

[C] National Remote Sensing Centre

[D] Wildlife Institute of India

Answer: Forest Survey of India

Recently, the Forest Survey of India (FSI) stopped sharing alerts from the Anavaran Deforestation Alert System with states regarding forest loss. The Anavaran Deforestation Alert System is operated by Forest Survey of India (FSI). The Anavaran portal started in 2024 to monitor deforestation using satellite technology. It used satellite data and Machine Learning (ML) to detect forest cover loss and send location-based alerts every 15 days for field inspection. The system runs on Google Earth Engine (GEE) for large-scale geospatial data analysis. It uses Sentinel-2 images and integrates Sentinel-1 Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) for monitoring during cloudy or monsoon periods.

84. Sheshnaag-150 is developed by which organization?

[A] Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)



- [B] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- [C] NewSpace Research and Technologies (NRT)
- [D] Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

Answer: NewSpace Research and Technologies (NRT)

Sheshnaag-150 is a long-range swarm attack drone being developed in India for deep-strike military missions. It is being developed by NewSpace Research and Technologies (NRT), which focuses on Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based unmanned systems and swarm robotics. It is a collaborative swarm drone, meaning multiple drones can coordinate autonomously to carry out saturation attacks on targets. The drone weighs around 150 kg and can carry 25–40 kg payload, including explosive warheads capable of damaging infrastructure or military vehicles.

85. Sinhagad Fort, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Tamil Nadu

Answer: Maharashtra

Recently, about 25 visitors were injured after a swarm of bees attacked tourists at Sinhagad Fort, bringing the historic site into news. Sinhagad, earlier known as Kondhana, is an ancient hill fortress located near Pune, Maharashtra, in the Sahyadri range and is believed to be around 2,000 years old. The fort was captured in 1340 CE by Muhammad bin Tughlaq and later controlled by the Nizam Shahi dynasty. Shivaji captured the fort in 1647, but it was handed to the Mughals under the Treaty of Purandar. It was recaptured in 1670 by Tanaji Malusare during the Battle of Sinhagad, where he sacrificed his life. After this victory, the fort was renamed Sinhagad (Lion's Fort).

86. Which state secured the top rank in the national implementation of the Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System (ICJS) 2.0?

- [A] Haryana
- [B] Uttarakhand
- [C] Assam
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Uttarakhand

Uttarakhand ranked 1st in implementing the Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System (ICJS) 2.0, scoring 93.46 on the progress dashboard. The ranking is released by National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) based on the Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems (CCTNS) performance. Haryana, Assam, Sikkim, and Madhya Pradesh followed in the rankings. ICJS 2.0 connects Police (CCTNS), e-Courts, e-Prisons, e-Prosecution and e-Forensics through a "one data, one entry" system for seamless data sharing. It supports the implementation of new criminal laws—Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA).

87. Which bank became the first in India to issue domestic green bonds?



- [A] State Bank of India
- [B] HDFC Bank
- [C] Bank of Baroda
- [D] ICICI Bank

Answer: Bank of Baroda

Bank of Baroda raised ₹10,000 crore by issuing long-term green infrastructure bonds, becoming the first bank in India to issue domestic green bonds. The 7-year bond was issued on the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) through the Electronic Book Provider (EBP) platform. The issue had a ₹5,000 crore base size with a ₹5,000 crore greenshoe option, and received bids worth ₹16,415 crore, showing strong investor demand. The bank fixed a 7.1% annual coupon rate despite market volatility.

88. Which Indian city is the host of World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026?

- [A] Hyderabad
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Mumbai
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

The World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026 is held in New Delhi from 11–13 March 2026. It is a major international para-sports event bringing together about more than 250 athletes from different countries. Athletes from India, Russia, Nepal, Bhutan, Hong Kong, Serbia, Bosnia and Herzegovina and Egypt are participating. India has the largest contingent with about 219 athletes competing in multiple classifications. The event will feature high-level track and field competitions, promoting global participation in para athletics.

89. Bharat Taxi is a cooperative-led mobility initiative established under which act?

- [A] Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002
- [B] Companies Act, 2013
- [C] Societies Registration Act, 1860
- [D] Indian Trusts Act, 1882

Answer: Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002

Bharat Taxi is a cooperative-led mobility initiative promoting driver ownership, governance, and value creation. It was established on 6 June 2025 under the Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002. It was officially launched on 5 February 2026. Currently operational in Delhi NCR (Delhi, Gurugram, Noida, Faridabad, Ghaziabad) and Gujarat (Ahmedabad, Rajkot, Somnath, Dwarka) with phased national expansion planned over two years. Zero-commission model ensures direct profit distribution to driver-owners (Sarathis), promoting livelihood, self-employment, and inclusive local economic growth.

90. Where was National Conference of Women Elected Representatives of Panchayats 2026 held?

- [A] Hyderabad
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Mumbai
- [D] New Delhi

**Answer: New Delhi**

The National Conference of Women Elected Representatives of Panchayats under Sashakt Panchayat-Netri Abhiyan was held on 11 March 2026 in New Delhi. About 700 participants, including Women Elected Representatives and UN agency representatives, attended. Outstanding Beacon Women Panchayat Leaders were honoured. A Compendium of Best Practices, transformation stories, and Nirbhaya initiatives were launched. Technical sessions focused on Women Leadership and Decision-making and Model Women Friendly Gram Panchayats.

91. The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) functions under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Defence
- [B] Ministry of Finance
- [C] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [D] Ministry of Civil Aviation

Answer: Ministry of Home Affairs

India celebrates the Raising Day of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) on 10 March to recognise its role in protecting key national infrastructure. Central Industrial Security Force is a Central Armed Police Force under the Ministry of Home Affairs. It provides security to about 70 airports and 361 critical national installations such as industries and strategic assets. The headquarter is located in New Delhi and motto is "Protection and Security".

92. Roopkund Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Himachal Pradesh
- [D] Uttarakhand

Answer: Uttarakhand

Roopkund Lake, popularly called Skeleton Lake, is a small glacial lake famous for hundreds of human skeletons found around it. It lies at 5,029 metres (16,500 ft) in the Garhwal Himalayas near the base of Mount Trishul, Uttarakhand. The lake is only about 130 feet wide and remains frozen for most of the year, revealing skeletons when ice melts. Skeletons were first noticed in 1942 by a British forest ranger. Scientific studies using radiocarbon dating and DNA analysis found over 300 individuals.

93. Which two organizations recently conducted the in-flight release trials of the indigenous Air Droppable Container (ADC-150)?

- [A] Defence Research and Development Organisation and Indian Navy
- [B] Indian Space Research Organisation and Indian Air Force
- [C] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited and Indian Coast Guard
- [D] Bharat Electronics Limited and Indian Army

Answer: Defence Research and Development Organisation and Indian Navy

Defence Research and Development Organisation and the Indian Navy successfully conducted four in-flight release trials of the ADC-150 (Air Droppable Container-150) from



the Boeing P-8I Poseidon near Goa. ADC-150 is an indigenously developed container capable of carrying 150 kg payload for aerial delivery. The parachute system was developed by Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment. Instrumentation support came from Defence Research and Development Laboratory. The system enables rapid aerial delivery of equipment, supplies and medical aid to naval ships operating in open sea or emergencies.

94. Which Indian city is the host of Global Conference on Women in Agri-Food Systems (GCWAS-2026)?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Mumbai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

A three-day Global Conference on Women in Agri-Food Systems (GCWAS-2026) was held from 12–14 March 2026 at ICAR Convention Centre, New Delhi. It was organised by Indian Council of Agricultural Research, Trust for Advancement of Agricultural Sciences, Consultative Group on International Agricultural Research and Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority. The Theme is "Driving Progress, Attaining New Heights." It was organised during the 2026 International Year for Women Farmers.

95. Which city's cantonment board launched the Swachhata Monitoring & Automated Reporting Tool (SMART) tool to improve sanitation?

- [A] Delhi
- [B] Pune
- [C] Agra
- [D] Meerut

Answer: Delhi

Delhi Cantonment Board launched the Swachhata Monitoring & Automated Reporting Tool (SMART) to improve sanitation and civic service monitoring. SMART automates data collection, reporting and performance tracking, replacing manual systems that caused delays and fragmented monitoring. The system uses a four-tier monitoring structure: Supervisors submit updates, ASIs verify, Officers In-Charge track, and CEO reviews consolidated reports. AI-enabled analytics are being integrated to minimise human intervention, identify recurring issues, classify problems, generate intelligent alerts, and prioritise critical areas.

96. Which authority has launched its first structured Bug Bounty Programme to strengthen the security of the Aadhaar system?

- [A] National Informatics Centre
- [B] Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)
- [C] Cyber and Information Security Division
- [D] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)



Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) launched its first structured Bug Bounty Programme to strengthen Aadhaar system security. The programme invites cybersecurity experts and ethical hackers to identify vulnerabilities in key UIDAI platforms, including the UIDAI official website, myAadhaar portal, and Secure QR Code application. A panel of 20 experienced researchers has been selected to examine systems for Critical, High, Medium, and Low risk vulnerabilities. UIDAI already uses security audits, vulnerability assessments, penetration testing, and continuous monitoring, and the Bug Bounty adds an independent layer of protection.

97. Mission Mausam is implemented by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- [B] Ministry of Earth Sciences
- [C] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [D] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer: Ministry of Earth Sciences

The Government of India launched Mission Mausam to improve accuracy, lead time, and reliability of weather forecasts, climate services, and early warnings for disaster management. It is implemented by the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) through institutions like the India Meteorological Department (IMD), Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), and National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting (NCMRWF). The objectives is strengthening observation networks, enhancing numerical weather prediction models, expanding high-performance computing (HPC) capacity, and improving last-mile dissemination.

98. No Smoking Day 2026 is observed on which day?

- [A] March 9
- [B] March 10
- [C] March 11
- [D] March 12

Answer: March 11

No Smoking Day 2026 is observed on 11 March 2026 to encourage people to quit tobacco and adopt healthier lifestyles. The campaign spreads awareness about the harmful effects of smoking and supports people overcoming nicotine addiction. It was first launched in 1984 in the United Kingdom and is now observed every year on the second Wednesday of March. Governments and health organisations use the day to promote tobacco cessation programmes and public health awareness campaigns.

99. What are "Caulocera hollowayi and Asura buxa" that were recently mentioned in news?

- [A] Newly discovered moth species
- [B] Traditional medicinal plants
- [C] Coral species
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Newly discovered moth species

Scientists from Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) discovered two new lichen moth species:



Caulocera hollowayi and *Asura buxa* in the eastern Himalayas. *Caulocera hollowayi* was found near Golitar, Sikkim and identified through unique wing patterns, colour bands, and microscopic body structures. *Asura buxa* was discovered at Panihpora, West Bengal, recognised by distinct wing colours and unique internal anatomical features. Lichen moth caterpillars feed on lichens, organisms extremely sensitive to air pollution. Since lichens react quickly to polluted air, the presence or absence of these moths helps scientists monitor air quality and ecosystem health.

100. Asteroid 2024 YR4 was discovered by which telescope?

- [A] Hubble Space Telescope
- [B] Asteroid Terrestrial-impact Last Alert System (ATLAS)
- [C] James Webb Space Telescope
- [D] Giant Magellan Telescope (GMT)

Answer: Asteroid Terrestrial-impact Last Alert System (ATLAS)

Asteroid 2024 YR4 was recently confirmed by NASA to not collide with the Moon in 2032. It is an Apollo-type asteroid, meaning its orbit crosses Earth's orbit but remains mostly outside it. It was discovered in 2024 by the Asteroid Terrestrial-impact Last Alert System (ATLAS) telescope in Chile. In its name, Y indicates discovery in the second half of December, while R4 shows it was the 117th asteroid identified in that period. It is a Near-Earth Object (NEO) with size about 174–220 feet (53–67 metres). It likely originated from the central Main Asteroid Belt between Mars and Jupiter.

101. According to the US Department of Agriculture (USDA), which country became the largest supplier of cotton products to the US in 2025?

- [A] China
- [B] Vietnam
- [C] India
- [D] Bangladesh

Answer: India

India became the largest supplier of cotton products (apparel and home textiles) to the United States in 2025, replacing China, according to the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA). US imports of cotton products remained stable at 3.3 million tonnes, close to the 15-year average. Imports from China fell to about 0.5 million tonnes, while India exported around 0.6 million tonnes to the US. High US tariffs on China (10–125%) and diversification of supply chains reduced dependence on China. India benefits from vertically integrated textile supply chains, helping meet traceability standards. The Uyghur Forced Labor Prevention Act (UFLPA) and geopolitical risks also reduced US sourcing from China.

102. Which state government has approved the draft of the Freedom of Religion Bill in March 2026?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Jharkhand
- [C] Bihar



[D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Chhattisgarh

Chhattisgarh government approved the draft Freedom of Religion Bill, 2026 in a Cabinet meeting at Raipur. The Bill aims to prevent religious conversions through force, inducement, fraud, undue influence, or misrepresentation. It focuses on regulating conversion from one religion to another within the state. The proposed law will be introduced in the ongoing Budget Session of the Chhattisgarh Legislative Assembly. The objective is to strengthen legal measures against unlawful religious conversions in the state.

103. World Kidney Day 2026 is observed on which day?

[A] March 11

[B] March 12

[C] March 13

[D] March 14

Answer: March 12

World Kidney Day 2026 is observed on March 12, 2026 to raise awareness about Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD). The campaign is led by the International Society of Nephrology (ISN) and International Federation of Kidney Foundations (IFKF). The 2026 theme is “Kidney Health for All: Caring for People, Protecting the Planet”, linking kidney health to environmental factors like pollution, extreme heat, and unsafe water.

104. INS Trikand, that was recently seen in news, belongs to which class of warships?

[A] Shivalik-class stealth frigate

[B] Talwar-class guided missile frigate

[C] Kolkata-class destroyer

[D] Kamorta-class corvette

Answer: Talwar-class guided missile frigate

INS Trikand will participate in the 58th National Day celebrations of Mauritius, reflecting India–Mauritius maritime cooperation. It is a Talwar-class guided-missile frigate of the Indian Navy and the third and final ship of the second batch of this class. The ship was built at Yantar Shipyard, Kaliningrad in Russia and commissioned on 29 June 2013 at Kaliningrad. It operates under the Western Fleet of the Western Naval Command (WNC) headquartered at Mumbai.

105. Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

[A] Madhya Pradesh

[B] Rajasthan

[C] Gujarat

[D] Haryana

Answer: Madhya Pradesh

Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary is located in Madhya Pradesh and spans across three districts—Sagar, Damoh, and Narsinghpur. It covers about 1187 square kilometres, making it the largest wildlife sanctuary in the state. The sanctuary lies on a plateau in the



Upper Vindhyan Range, providing suitable habitat for wildlife. It functions as an ecological corridor linking Panna Tiger Reserve, Satpura Tiger Reserve, and Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve. The region belongs to the Deccan Peninsula biogeographic zone, supporting diverse forests and fauna. It is planned to receive cheetahs soon under India's cheetah reintroduction efforts to expand suitable habitats for the species

106. Kavach is an Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system developed by which organization?

- [A] Centre for Railway Research and Safety (CRRS)
- [B] Research Design and Standards Organisation (RDSO)
- [C] Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- [D] Indian Railways Institute of Signal Engineering

Answer: Research Design and Standards Organisation (RDSO)

Kavach 4.0 has been successfully commissioned on 1,452 route km of Delhi-Mumbai and Delhi-Howrah corridors. Kavach is an indigenous Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system that prevents train collisions by automatically controlling speed and braking if the loco pilot fails. It is developed by Research Design and Standards Organisation (RDSO) in collaboration with Indian industry. The system aims for Zero Accidents by preventing Signal Passing at Danger (SPAD), controlling overspeeding, and ensuring safety in adverse weather like fog.

107. Which ministry has implemented the Global Engagement Scheme to promote India's rich cultural heritage internationally?

- [A] Ministry of External Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Culture
- [C] Ministry of Tourism
- [D] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: Ministry of Culture

Ministry of Culture implements the Global Engagement Scheme to promote India's cultural heritage internationally and enhance its global image. The objective is to strengthen cultural ties with foreign nations, promote bilateral cultural contacts, project India's cultural identity, and encourage inbound tourism. The scheme has three components: Festival of India (FoI), Grant-in-aid to Indo-Foreign Friendship Cultural Societies and contributions to inter-governmental Organizations.

108. Which port became the first in India to launch the Digital Twin initiative for port management?

- [A] Jawaharlal Nehru Port, Mumbai
- [B] V.O. Chidambaranar Port, Tamil Nadu
- [C] Kandla Port, Gujarat
- [D] Paradip Port, Odisha

Answer: V.O. Chidambaranar Port, Tamil Nadu

V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority became the first Indian port to launch the Digital Twin initiative for port management on 23 February 2026. Digital Twin creates a real-time virtual replica of the port's infrastructure, assets, and maritime ecosystem for enhanced



visibility, predictive analytics, and data-driven decision-making. Features include real-time monitoring of berth occupancy, vessel movements, crane utilisation, yard capacity, predictive maintenance, and berth/traffic optimisation. It supports energy and emissions tracking, scenario simulation, and “what-if” modelling for peak demand and operational disruptions.

109. What is the name of the scheme launched by government to provide cashless treatment to road accident victims?

- [A] Ayushman Bharat – Road Care Scheme
- [B] PM-RAHAT Scheme
- [C] National Road Safety Health Scheme
- [D] Emergency Accident Medical Assistance Scheme

Answer: PM-RAHAT Scheme

The PM-RAHAT Scheme provides cashless treatment up to ₹1.5 lakh for road accident victims for up to 7 days from the accident, regardless of road type. It was launched on 13 February 2026 under Section 162 of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 by the Prime Minister; notified by Union Minister Nitin Gadkari. Victims will receive stabilisation treatment for up to 24 hours in non-life-threatening cases and up to 48 hours in life-threatening situations at designated hospitals, subject to police verification. The scheme is implemented by integrating the Electronic Detailed Accident Report (eDAR) platform used by police with the Transaction Management System (TMS 2.0) used by hospitals to manage treatment records, claims, and payments.

110. Which international organization has declared 2026 as the International Year of the Woman Farmer (IYWF)?

- [A] World Bank
- [B] Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)
- [C] International Labour Organization (ILO)
- [D] United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

Answer: Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)

The United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) has declared 2026 as the International Year of the Woman Farmer (IYWF 2026). A workforce shift is occurring as rural men move to non-farm jobs, leading women to increasingly take on agricultural roles. Women’s participation in agriculture has surged by 135% in a decade, now constituting 42% of the agricultural workforce. Two in three working women are engaged in agriculture, though this remains lower than global averages of 57%-63%. In 2023-24, there were 117.6 million women in agriculture: 21.7 million hired, 95.1 million self-employed, and 0.8 million regular workers.

111. The National Shipping Board (NSB) works under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Defence
- [B] Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways
- [C] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [D] Ministry of Transport

**Answer: Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways**

The government held a high-level interaction with the National Shipping Board (NSB) to address emerging challenges in India's shipping sector amid evolving global geopolitical dynamics. The NSB is India's apex advisory body on shipping and maritime matters, constituted under Section 23 of the Merchant Shipping Act, 1958. It functions under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways and advises the central government on shipping policies and maritime development. The chairperson of the NSB is appointed by the Central Government.

112. Which international body adopted the new global framework "Agreed Conclusions" to improve access to justice for women and girls worldwide?

- [A] International Court of Justice (ICJ)
- [B] World Bank
- [C] European Union (EU)
- [D] United Nations (UN)

Answer: United Nations (UN)

The United Nations adopted a new global framework called Agreed Conclusions to improve access to justice for women and girls worldwide. The framework was adopted by broad consensus during the 70th session of the Commission on the Status of Women (CSW) held in New York, United States. The Agreed Conclusions framework is not legally binding, serving as a guideline for member states to strengthen justice systems for women and girls. A key recommendation is to repeal discriminatory laws that negatively affect women and girls in any sphere of life. The framework emphasizes the need to strengthen protection against violence, both online and offline, and ensure faster access to justice for survivors.

113. The National Dam Safety Authority (NDSA) functions under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Water Resources
- [B] Ministry of Jal Shakti
- [C] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [D] Ministry of Power

Answer: Ministry of Jal Shakti

Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Paatil, inaugurated the new office of the National Dam Safety Authority (NDSA) and launched its official website. The event introduced digital tools to strengthen dam safety monitoring. NDSA is a statutory body established under the Dam Safety Act, 2021 to regulate dam safety in India. It functions under the Ministry of Jal Shakti and ensures the structural integrity and safe operation of specified dams nationwide. NDSA implements policies framed by the National Committee on Dam Safety (NCDS) and oversees national dam safety standards.

114. Which two countries launched the Centenary Sports Cooperation Programme to celebrate 100 years of sporting relations?

- [A] India and Australia
- [B] India and New Zealand



- [C] India and England
- [D] India and South Africa

Answer: India and New Zealand

India and New Zealand launched the Centenary Sports Cooperation Programme to celebrate 100 years of bilateral sporting relations. The centenary commemorates the 1926 Indian Army hockey tour to New Zealand, one of the earliest major sports engagements between the two countries. The programme focuses on six priority sports for collaborative development: rugby, rowing, canoeing, sailing, athletics, and cycling. New Zealand's coach development framework will be integrated into the curriculum of the National Institute of Sports (NIS), Patiala. A Sports and Culture Week is proposed to showcase athletes, coaches, and indigenous sporting traditions from both nations.

115. Kurumba art, that was recently seen in news, originated mainly in which region of India?

- [A] Western Himalayas
- [B] Chotanagpur plateau
- [C] Nilgiri Hills region of South India
- [D] Thar Desert

Answer: Nilgiri Hills region of South India

Kurumba Art is an ancient tribal painting tradition now facing the threat of extinction. It is a prehistoric art form estimated to be over 3000 years old, created by the Kurumba Tribe living in Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Karnataka. Traditionally, the paintings were made on rocks and cave walls in the high hills of the Nilgiri Hills. Artists prepare natural pigments from forest resources, such as yellow-brown and black from Vengai tree resin and green from crushed leaves. They use simple tools like fine twigs, bamboo sticks, and brushes made from natural fibres to create the paintings.

116. Where was Yoga Mahotsav 2026 held?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] Hyderabad
- [C] Mumbai
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

Yoga Mahotsav 2026 was inaugurated in New Delhi by Prataprao Jadhav, marking the 100-day countdown to the 12th International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026. The event launched "10 Yoga Protocols for Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs)", where NCDs (Non-Communicable Diseases) include lifestyle illnesses such as diabetes, hypertension, and heart disease. The programme is organised by the Ministry of Ayush, the nodal ministry responsible for promoting IDY globally. A special "Yoga for Air Travel" protocol was introduced, consisting of a 5-minute seated routine of yogic postures, breathing exercises, and short meditation to reduce travel stress and improve blood circulation during flights.

117. Where was National Conference on Cold Water Fisheries 2026 held?

- [A] Srinagar
- [B] Mumbai



[C] Dehradun

[D] Chandigarh

Answer: Srinagar

The National Conference on Cold Water Fisheries was held on 14 March 2026 at Sher-e-Kashmir International Conference Centre, Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir, organised by the Department of Fisheries India. It is the first national dialogue focused on sustainable development of Cold-Water fisheries in India's high-altitude regions. Cold-water fisheries are found mainly in Himalayas, parts of the Northeast, and peninsular highlands, covering about 5.33 lakh sq. km across states such as Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, and Arunachal Pradesh.

118. What is the name of the operation launched by the DRI to bust an illegal Alprazolam manufacturing facility in Andhra Pradesh?

[A] Operation Clean Drug

[B] Operation Narcotic Strike

[C] Operation Drug Shield

[D] Operation White Hammer

Answer: Operation White Hammer

The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence busted a clandestine drug manufacturing unit under "Operation White Hammer" in Kondapalli Industrial Development Area of NTR district, Andhra Pradesh. The facility was secretly producing Alprazolam, a psychotropic substance regulated under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act 1985. The intelligence-based operation was conducted on 11–12 March 2026, exposing a large-scale illegal manufacturing unit operating under the cover of a chemical factory.

119. Nevado Ojos del Salado, that was recently seen in news, lies on the international boundary between which two countries?

[A] Chile and Bolivia

[B] Argentina and Chile

[C] France and Germany

[D] Mongolia and Russia

Answer: Argentina and Chile

A professor from the Indian Institute of Science recently summited Nevado Ojos del Salado. It is located in the Andes Mountains on the border between Chile and Argentina. With a height of 6,893 meters, it is the highest mountain in Chile and the highest active stratovolcano in the world. The mountain formed mainly from layers of lava flows and explosive volcanic materials, typical of stratovolcano formation.

120. The National Dialogue on Online Crimes Against Women and Children (OCWC) was organised by which organisation?

[A] Central Bureau of Investigation

[B] Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre

[C] National Investigation Agency

[D] National Crime Records Bureau

**Answer: Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre**

Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan inaugurated the National Dialogue on Online Crimes Against Women and Children in New Delhi to strengthen efforts against cyber crimes targeting vulnerable groups. The event was organised by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under the Ministry of Home Affairs. It brought together stakeholders from government agencies, law enforcement, digital platforms, academia, and civil society to develop strategies for tackling online crimes against women and children. The initiative is part of the government's broader effort led by Narendra Modi and guided by Amit Shah to ensure a safe and secure digital environment.

121. The Sujal Gaon ID initiative has been launched under which flagship programme?

- [A] Atal Bhujal Yojana
- [B] National Rural Drinking Water Programme
- [C] Jal Jeevan Mission
- [D] AMRUT Mission

Answer: Jal Jeevan Mission

The Union Minister of Jal Shakti recently released the Sujal Gaon ID to strengthen digital monitoring of rural water supply. Sujal Gaon ID is a scheme-based unique digital identifier used for complete digital mapping of rural piped water supply assets. These IDs have been created for villages across 31 States and Union Territories (UTs). Each Sujal Gaon ID is linked with Sujalam Bharat ID for integrated digital records. It works under the "Sujalam Bharat" national digital architecture, which maps the entire rural water supply chain from source to tap. The initiative has been launched by the Ministry of Jal Shakti under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM).

122. A new plant species named *Osbeckia zubeengargiana* was recently discovered from which state?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Mizoram
- [C] Tripura
- [D] West Bengal

Answer: Assam

Researchers from Gauhati University discovered a new plant species *Osbeckia zubeengargiana*. It was found in the grasslands of Manas National Park, Assam. The species is named after famous Assamese singer Zubeen Garg, a rare botanical tribute to a cultural icon. The plant belongs to the Melastomataceae, known for diverse tropical and subtropical shrubs. It is a perennial erect shrub adapted to grassland ecosystems. The plant has delicate purple to pink four-petalled (tetramerous) flowers. It grows well in moist soil conditions, increasing floral diversity in grasslands. It usually flowers and bears fruit from mid-September to January.

123. Joha Rice is an indigenous aromatic rice variety grown in which state?

- [A] Mizoram
- [B] Nagaland



[C] Assam

[D] Tripura

Answer: Assam

India recently exported 25 metric tonnes of Joha Rice to the United Kingdom and Italy. Joha Rice is an indigenous aromatic rice variety of Assam known for its distinct fragrance, fine grain, and rich taste. It is mainly cultivated during the Sali or Kharif season in Assam. Major varieties include Kola Joha, Keteki Joha, Bokul Joha, and Kunkuni Joha. The rice is rich in antioxidants, flavonoids, and phenolic compounds, giving nutritional benefits. It received the Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2017.

124. The Khadi Gramodyog Vikas Yojana (KGVY) is implemented by which organisation?

[A] National Small Industries Corporation

[B] National Skill Development Corporation

[C] Small Industries Development Bank of India

[D] Khadi and Village Industries Commission

Answer: Khadi and Village Industries Commission

Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) is a statutory body under the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises implementing Khadi Gramodyog Vikas Yojana (KGVY) for development of the khadi and village industries sector. Around 4.32 lakh spinners and weavers in the khadi sector benefit through wage enhancement based on spinning and weaving work. KVIC signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) in September 2025 with National Small Industries Corporation Limited (NSIC). The aim is to create an ecosystem for better market access for eligible Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) units.

125. Silverpit Crater, that was recently seen in news, is located in which sea?

[A] North Sea

[B] Red Sea

[C] Arabian sea

[D] Black sea

Answer: North Sea

New research confirmed that the Silverpit Crater was formed by a massive asteroid impact millions of years ago. It lies about 700 metres beneath the seabed in the North Sea, nearly 80 miles off the coast of Yorkshire. The crater was buried under thick sediment layers and was discovered only in 2002. It formed when a high-velocity space rock struck the seabed around 43–46 million years ago. Scientists found “shocked” quartz and feldspar crystals, which form only under extreme pressure during asteroid impacts. The crater is about 3 km wide and surrounded by circular faults extending nearly 20 km.

126. Which mining company has become the first in India to produce 50 million tonnes of iron ore in a single financial year (FY 2025–26)?

[A] Coal India Limited

[B] National Mineral Development Corporation

[C] Hindustan Copper Limited



[D] Vedanta Limited

Answer: National Mineral Development Corporation

National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC) Limited became the first mining company in India to produce 50 million tonnes of iron ore in a single financial year (2025–26). NMDC Limited is a Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) under the Ministry of Steel. It is the largest producer of iron ore in India and a key organisation for mineral resource development. Its aim is to explore, develop, and sustainably use mineral resources in India. It also ensures stable domestic supply of iron ore for the steel industry. NMDC supports India's goal to expand steel production capacity to 300 million tonnes by 2030.

127. International Day of Action for Rivers is observed every year on which day?

[A] March 13

[B] March 14

[C] March 15

[D] March 16

Answer: March 14

International Day of Action for Rivers is observed every year on 14 March to promote protection and sustainable management of rivers. Rivers provide fresh water, regulate climate, support biodiversity, and sustain livelihoods and cultures. Many rivers today face threats from pollution, fragmentation, climate change, and unsustainable development projects. The 2026 theme is "Protect Rivers, Protect People." The day encourages public awareness and collective action to conserve river ecosystems.

128. Which state government has recently renamed the Divyang Welfare Department as the Divyang Empowerment Department?

[A] Gujarat

[B] Maharashtra

[C] Karnataka

[D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Maharashtra

The Maharashtra Government has renamed the Divyang Welfare Department as the Divyang Empowerment Department. The change reflects a policy shift from welfare approach to empowerment and inclusion of persons with disabilities (Divyangjan). As per a Government Resolution, the department has also been restructured administratively. The Office of the Commissioner of Divyang Welfare will now be called the Office of Divyang Empowerment. At the district level, a Divyang Empowerment Office (DEO) will be established.

129. Which country topped the medal table at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026?

[A] India

[B] Russia

[C] Bosnia

[D] Peru

**Answer: India**

India topped the medal table at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026 – New Delhi leg held at Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium. India won 208 medals – 75 gold, 69 silver, and 64 bronze in the three-day competition. Russia finished second with 35 medals, while Bosnia and Herzegovina placed third with three medals. The event featured 257 athletes from eight countries and served as preparation for the 2026 World Para Athletics Championships and the 2028 Summer Paralympics.

130. Deepor Beel, that was recently seen in news, is a freshwater lake located in which state?

- [A] Manipur
- [B] Assam
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Nagaland

Answer: Assam

Illegal earth cutting is reported near Deepor Beel in Guwahati, despite restrictions by the Gauhati High Court and district administration. Deepor Beel is a permanent freshwater lake on the outskirts of Guwahati in Assam. It lies in a former channel of the Brahmaputra River; “Beel” means lake in Assamese. The wetland covers about 4.1 sq km and is among the largest lakes in the Brahmaputra Valley of Lower Assam. Main inflow rivers are Kalmani River and Basistha River, while outflow occurs through Khandajan rivulet joining the Brahmaputra. It functions as the main stormwater storage basin for Guwahati city.

131. Which organization released a report “Safe Disposal of Unused Medicines”?

- [A] World Health Organization
- [B] United Nations Development Programme
- [C] World Bank
- [D] United Nations Environment Programme

Answer: United Nations Environment Programme

A report “Safe Disposal of Unused Medicines” was released by United Nations Environment Programme. The report stresses waste prevention as the key strategy to manage unused medicines. Improper disposal causes environmental pollution and public health risks, including Antimicrobial Resistance, endocrine disruption, toxicity, and poisoning. The report promotes a One Health approach, integrating human health, animal health, and environmental protection. It suggests a four-pillar framework: prevention at source, medicine take-back schemes, strong legal and policy systems, and awareness programmes.

132. Henckelia monophylla, a rare plant species, is endemic to which state?

- [A] Arunachal Pradesh
- [B] Assam
- [C] Mizoram
- [D] Nagaland

Answer: Arunachal Pradesh

Scientists from the Botanical Survey of India rediscovered the rare plant Henckelia



monophylla after about 189 years. The species is endemic to Arunachal Pradesh and belongs to the Gesneriaceae. It was first collected in 1836 by British botanist William Griffith in the Mishmi Hills. It is a perennial herb growing in moist forest habitats. Plants of genus Henckelia usually have upright or slightly trailing stems with simple ovate or lance-shaped leaves.

133. Who won the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 for the English novel *Crimson Spring*?

- [A] Amitav Ghosh
- [B] Navtej Sarna
- [C] Shashi Tharoor
- [D] Chetan Bhagat

Answer: Navtej Sarna

Sahitya Akademi announced the Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025, recognising outstanding literary works in 24 Indian languages. The awards cover genres like poetry, novels, short stories, essays, literary criticism, autobiography and memoirs. Selected works include 8 poetry collections, 4 novels, 6 short story collections, 2 essay volumes, 1 literary criticism work, 1 autobiography and 2 memoirs. Notable winners include Navtej Sarna for English novel *Crimson Spring*, Mamta Kalia for Hindi memoir *Jeete Jee Allahabad*, and N. Prabhakaran for Malayalam novel *Maayaamanushyar*.

134. Which tennis player won the 2026 Indian Wells Masters title?

- [A] Jannik Sinner
- [B] Novak Djokovic
- [C] Daniil Medvedev
- [D] Carlos Alcaraz

Answer: Jannik Sinner

Tennis player Jannik Sinner won his first Indian Wells title by defeating Daniil Medvedev 7-6(6), 7-6(4) in the final played in California. The Italian produced a strong performance with 28 winners and 10 aces. With this victory, Sinner became only the third player to win all six hard-court ATP Masters 1000 titles, joining Novak Djokovic and Roger Federer. The win was also his first title of 2026, extending his Masters 1000 winning streak to 11 matches, while Medvedev reached the final after defeating Carlos Alcaraz in the semi-final but finished runner-up for the third time at Indian Wells.

135. A new estuarine fish species named *Butis bargabhimae* was recently discovered in which state?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Odisha
- [C] West Bengal
- [D] Kerala

Answer: West Bengal

Scientists in West Bengal have discovered a new estuarine fish species named *Butis bargabhimae* in the Rupnarayan River, a tributary of the Hooghly River near Tamluk, West Bengal. *Butis bargabhimae* belongs to the butid family, commonly known as gudgeon.



goby, which usually live in brackish water where rivers meet the sea. The species is unique because it has interorbital scales (scales between the eyes), unlike most related fish which have smooth areas there. It also has additional auxiliary scales across its body, making it structurally distinct. The fish shows clear light and dark bands on its pectoral fins, which are absent in similar species.

136. Which state government has launched Gaudham Yojana to manage stray and abandoned cattle?

- [A] Jharkhand
- [B] Chhattisgarh
- [C] Bihar
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Chhattisgarh

In March 2026, Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai launched the Gaudham Yojana at Bilaspur to manage stray and abandoned cattle. The scheme aims to set up 1,460 Gaudhams (cattle shelters) across the state with about 10 shelters in each development block. Each shelter will have a capacity of around 200 cattle and all will be named Surabhi Gaudham. In the first phase, 29 Gaudhams across 11 districts were virtually inaugurated. These centres will also provide training in animal husbandry, green fodder cultivation, and value-added products (VAP) from cow dung.

137. Exercise Sea Dragon 2026 was hosted by which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] Australia
- [C] India
- [D] Japan

Answer: United States

The Indian Navy deployed a P-8I maritime patrol aircraft to Guam to join the US-led Sea Dragon anti-submarine warfare (ASW) exercise 2026. The exercise includes QUAD partners: United States, India, Australia, Japan, and also New Zealand. Multiple P-8 aircraft participate, enabling better coordination due to similar systems, sensors, and data-link capabilities. The drill improves ASW skills by training crews from simulated targets to real submarine detection with 200+ flight hours. Joint classroom sessions are also conducted to refine tactics and coordination. The deployment comes as India ensures safe passage of merchant ships in the Arabian Sea for energy security.

138. Exercise "Freedom Shield" 2026 is conducted between United States and which country?

- [A] South Korea
- [B] China
- [C] Australia
- [D] India

Answer: South Korea

The United States and South Korea conducted the joint military exercise "Freedom Shield" involving thousands of troops. Around 18,000 South Korean troops are participating, while



the number of United States troops is not officially confirmed. The exercise continued till 19 March 2026 and focuses on defence preparedness and coordination. North Korea strongly opposes such exercises, viewing them as a rehearsal for invasion. These drills often trigger reactions from North Korea, including missile tests and military demonstrations.

139. A freshwater crab species *Vela carli*, that was recently seen in news, is endemic to which region of India?

- [A] Western Ghats
- [B] Eastern Ghats
- [C] Himalayas
- [D] Chotanagpur plateau

Answer: Western Ghats

Researchers in Silent Valley National Park discovered a freshwater crab species *Vela carli* showing both male and female traits at the same time. *Vela carli* is an endemic species found only in the forests and streams of the Central Western Ghats. It belongs to the family Gecarcinucidae, which includes freshwater crabs. The crab showed gynandromorphy, a rare condition where an organism has both male and female characteristics. Its body had male reproductive structures along with female features like gonopores. This phenomenon is extremely rare in crustaceans and has never been reported earlier in the Gecarcinucidae family.

140. What are Petroglyphs that were recently mentioned in news?

- [A] Images engraved or carved on rock surfaces
- [B] Paintings made using natural dyes
- [C] Sculptures made of clay
- [D] Metal inscriptions

Answer: Images engraved or carved on rock surfaces

Researchers discovered two ancient petroglyphs near Beerappa Temple in Manchirevula, Telangana, inside a rock shelter. Petroglyphs are rock engravings made by removing surface material using techniques like pecking, incising, drilling, and polishing. They differ from petrographs, which are painted or drawn images on rocks. The term comes from Greek words “petros” (stone) and “glyphein” (to carve). Petroglyphs appear as scratches or deep carvings and are linked to prehistoric human activity. They are found worldwide except Antarctica, with major presence in Africa, Americas, Europe, Siberia, and Australia. In India, Edakkal Caves in Kerala is a famous example.

141. Where was COP30 climate summit held?

- [A] Bolivia
- [B] Peru
- [C] Chile
- [D] Brazil

Answer: Brazil

COP30 climate summit held in Belém, Brazil focused on protecting tropical forests and



global climate challenges. Discussions highlighted that forest conservation is not only about funding but also about control, governance, and local participation. Brazil introduced the Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF) as an innovative global financing mechanism. TFFF aims to shift the approach from reducing deforestation to rewarding countries for preserving existing forests. It recognises the ecological value of standing forests and promotes long-term conservation. The initiative has raised concerns about inclusion, equity, and accountability in decision-making.

142. Kanha Tiger Reserve is located in which state?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Madhya Pradesh

Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve will translocate around 50 wild Asiatic water buffaloes to Kanha Tiger Reserve in Madhya Pradesh in phases. The aim is to support species conservation and create a viable population in a new habitat. Kanha Tiger Reserve is located in the Maikal ranges of the Satpura Hills in Madhya Pradesh. It has an active wildlife corridor with Pench Tiger Reserve, ensuring animal movement and genetic diversity. Kanha is also connected to Achanakmar Tiger Reserve in Chhattisgarh, forming a larger conservation landscape.

143. Prambanan Temple, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] South Africa
- [B] Chile
- [C] Japan
- [D] Indonesia

Answer: Indonesia

India and Indonesia have partnered to restore the Prambanan Temple complex in Yogyakarta, Southern Java. Prambanan is the largest Hindu temple complex in Indonesia, located in Sleman region. It is locally known as Roro Jonggrang, meaning "Temple of the Slender Virgin." The temple was built in the 9th century by the Sanjaya dynasty. It is dedicated to the Hindu Trimurti: Brahma, Vishnu, and Shiva. The complex remained buried for centuries and was rediscovered in the 19th century. It was declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1991.

144. The Floating LiDAR Buoy System has been developed by which institute?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organisation
- [B] Defence Research and Development Organisation
- [C] National Institute of Ocean Technology
- [D] Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology

Answer: National Institute of Ocean Technology

National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT) tested an indigenously developed Floating LiDAR Buoy System off Muttom coast, Tamil Nadu. It is a high-tech ocean instrument that



measures wind conditions using LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging) technology. The system combines a floating buoy with laser-based sensors to study atmospheric conditions over the sea. It emits laser pulses that reflect from air particles, and the returned signals are analysed to measure wind speed, direction, and patterns. It can capture detailed wind data up to 300 metres above sea level, which is better than traditional instruments.

145. What kind of disease is 'Melanoma' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Fungal disease
- [B] Skin cancer
- [C] Bacterial disease
- [D] Blood cancer

Answer: Skin cancer

Researchers at the U.S. National Institutes of Health discovered that cholesterol present in the membrane around the cell nucleus plays a role in promoting the spread of melanoma, a type of skin cancer. Melanoma originates in melanocytes, which are specialized cells responsible for producing melanin, the pigment that gives color to the skin. This type of cancer typically develops on areas of the skin that are frequently exposed to the sun, such as the arms, back, face, and legs, although it can occasionally appear inside the body, including in the nose or throat. Ultraviolet (UV) light exposure, whether from sunlight or artificial sources like tanning lamps and beds, is the main cause of most melanomas, although other factors may also contribute.

146. Ordnance Factory Day 2026 is celebrated on which day every year in India?

- [A] March 17
- [B] March 18
- [C] March 19
- [D] March 20

Answer: March 18

Ordnance Factory Day 2026 is celebrated across India on 18 March to honour the country's legacy in defence manufacturing and self-reliance. The day commemorates the beginning of production at India's first ordnance factory in Cossipore, Kolkata, in 1802, highlighting its historical importance in strengthening national security. India's ordnance manufacturing network consists of 41 factories employing over 70,000 personnel, contributing significantly to defence preparedness. These factories produce a wide range of defence equipment, including small arms, artillery, armoured vehicles, parachutes, and military electronics, and also export products to more than 30 countries.

147. What is the name of scheme recently approved by Union Cabinet for promoting small hydro projects (1–25 MW)?

- [A] National Hydropower Mission
- [B] Green Energy Corridor Scheme
- [C] Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme
- [D] Jal Urja Vikas Yojana

**Answer: Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme**

The Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi has approved the Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme for the period FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31 with a total outlay of ₹2,584.60 crore. The scheme aims to install around 1500 MW capacity through small hydro power projects (1–25 MW each) across various states, especially benefiting hilly and North Eastern regions. In North Eastern states and border districts, the scheme provides central financial assistance of ₹3.6 crore per MW or 30% of project cost (whichever is lower), with a maximum limit of ₹30 crore per project. In other states, financial assistance is set at ₹2.4 crore per MW or 20% of project cost (whichever is lower), capped at ₹20 crore per project.

148. Where was the Bharat Electricity Summit 2026 held?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Mumbai
- [C] Chennai
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

The Bharat Electricity Summit 2026 is held from 19–22 March 2026 at Yashobhoomi, New Delhi, serving as a flagship global conference-cum-exhibition for the power and electricity sector. The Summit is expected to host over 100 conference sessions, 300+ speakers, participants from 80+ countries, 500+ exhibitors (including 100+ startups), and over 25,000 visitors, making it one of the largest global electricity platforms. The theme of the Summit is “Electrifying Growth. Empowering Sustainability. Connecting Globally.”, focusing on growth, sustainability, and global collaboration in the energy sector.

149. The Integrated Programme for Senior Citizens (IPSrC) is a component of which scheme?

- [A] Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana
- [B] Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana
- [C] PM Jan Arogya Yojana
- [D] National Social Assistance Programme

Answer: Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana

The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment implements the Integrated Programme for Senior Citizens (IPSrC) under the umbrella scheme Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana (AVYAY) for the welfare of elderly people. Under IPSrC, the government provides grant-in-aid to eligible NGOs and voluntary organisations for running projects such as Senior Citizen Homes, Continuous Care Homes, Mobile Medicare Units, Physiotherapy Units, and Regional Resource and Training Centres (RRTCs). HelpAge India has been designated as one of the Regional Resource and Training Centres (RRTCs) under the scheme.

150. The “Krishi Sakhi Initiative” has been launched by which organization?

- [A] Food and Agriculture Organization
- [B] Agriculture Insurance Company of India Limited
- [C] Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- [D] NABARD

**Answer: Agriculture Insurance Company of India Limited**

In alignment with the declaration of 2026 as the 'International Year of the Woman Farmer' by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) under the United Nations, the Agriculture Insurance Company of India Limited (AIC) has launched the Krishi Sakhi Initiative to empower women farmers and promote inclusive growth in agriculture. The initiative aims to create sustained awareness, increase participation of women in agriculture and crop insurance, and recognize their contribution to strengthening the agricultural sector in India. It is being implemented through structured month-wise activities across AIC's Head Office and Regional Offices to ensure continuous engagement throughout the year.

151. Recently, which scheme was approved to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks in India?

- [A] National Industrial Corridor Scheme
- [B] Make in India 2.0
- [C] Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna
- [D] PM GatiShakti Yojana

Answer: Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna

The Union Cabinet chaired by Narendra Modi has approved the Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana (BHAVYA) with an allocation of ₹33,660 crore to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks across India. The scheme aims to create world-class industrial infrastructure, unlock manufacturing potential, and strengthen India's journey towards a Viksit Bharat (developed India). BHAVYA builds upon the success of industrial smart cities developed under the National Industrial Corridor Development Programme (NICDP) and will be implemented in partnership with states and private sector players.

152. The "Punjab Sikhya Kranti 2.0" initiative is related to which sector?

- [A] Health
- [B] Agriculture
- [C] Infrastructure
- [D] Education

Answer: Education

The Punjab Government has launched the second phase of school education reforms, 'Punjab Sikhya Kranti 2.0', to modernize and strengthen the state's education system. The programme is being implemented in collaboration with the World Bank, aiming to make Punjab's education system globally competitive. The initiative involves a total investment of ₹3,500 crore over the next six years, making it one of the largest education reform investments in the state's history.

153. Which state government has launched the Divyang Shakti Scheme to provide free bus travel for persons with disabilities across the state?

- [A] Bihar
- [B] Andhra Pradesh
- [C] Jharkhand
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Andhra Pradesh



The Andhra Pradesh Government has launched the Divyang Shakti Scheme to provide free bus travel for persons with disabilities across the state. It aims to enhance mobility and accessibility to public transport for persons with disabilities. The scheme will benefit over 12.76 lakh beneficiaries, including attendants. Eligible persons with more than 40% disability are allowed to travel free of cost in APSRTC buses. Attendants accompanying them receive a 50% fare concession.

154. Indian Ocean Ship (IOS) SAGAR initiative has been launched by which organization?

[A] Indian Coast Guard

[B] Indian Navy

[C] Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

[D] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

Answer: Indian Navy

The Indian Navy has commenced the second edition of the Indian Ocean Ship (IOS) SAGAR initiative from 16 March 2026, reinforcing India's commitment to maritime security and cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region. The initiative follows India's assumption of the chairmanship of the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium in February 2026 and includes participation from 16 member nations. IOS SAGAR is part of India's broader vision of SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region) and aligns with the MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security Across the Regions) framework. It aims to enhance maritime partnerships, improve interoperability, and strengthen regional security cooperation.

155. Who has been named the recipient of the Stockholm Water Prize 2026?

[A] Rajendra Singh

[B] Kaveh Madani

[C] Peter Gleick

[D] Johan Rockstrom

Answer: Kaveh Madani

Kaveh Madani has been named the 2026 recipient of the Stockholm Water Prize, which is considered the world's most prestigious award for water-related work. The prize has been awarded annually since 1991 by the Stockholm Water Foundation in collaboration with the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences. It recognizes individuals or organisations that make outstanding contributions to the conservation and protection of water resources and to the well-being of the planet and its inhabitants.

156. Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) operates under the administrative control of which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Agriculture

[B] Ministry of Textiles

[C] Ministry of Commerce

[D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Textiles

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) has approved Minimum Support Price (MSP) funding to the Cotton Corporation of India for the cotton season 2023–24. The



Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) was established on 31 July 1970 and functions as a Public Sector Undertaking under the Companies Act, 1956. It operates under the administrative control of the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India.

157. Bhumika Shrestha has become first transgender woman lawmaker of which country in March 2026?

- [A] Nepal
- [B] Bhutan
- [C] Myanmar
- [D] Bangladesh

Answer: Nepal

Bhumika Shrestha has become Nepal's first transgender woman lawmaker, marking a historic step toward inclusivity in South Asia. She officially entered Parliament on 16 March 2026 through the proportional representation system and is associated with the Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP). Her achievement follows political changes after 2025 protests, which led to fresh elections and the rise of new leadership in Nepal. It represents a major breakthrough for LGBTQ representation, giving the community a voice at the highest political level.

158. What is the rank of India in the World Happiness Report 2026?

- [A] 114th
- [B] 115th
- [C] 116th
- [D] 117th

Answer: 116th

The U.N.-backed World Happiness Report 2026 was released on 18 March 2026, highlighting global well-being trends and ranking Finland as the world's happiest country for the ninth consecutive year. The report emphasizes that heavy social media use is harming young people's well-being, prompting some countries to consider or implement legislative restrictions on social media for youth. Top 10 happiest countries are Finland, Iceland, Denmark, Costa Rica, Sweden, Norway, Netherlands, Israel, Luxembourg, Switzerland. Costa Rica achieved fourth place, marking the highest-ever ranking for a Latin American country. Among 147 countries, India ranks 116th, showing a slight improvement from 118th in 2025.

159. Patriot Missile Defence System is developed by which country?

- [A] Russia
- [B] China
- [C] France
- [D] United States

Answer: United States

The NATO is deploying the U.S. Patriot Missile Defence System to the southern province of Adana to strengthen regional air defence capabilities. PATRIOT stands for Phased Array Tracking Radar to Intercept on Target. It is a ground-based, mobile missile defence system



developed by the United States. The system is designed to detect, track, and intercept aerial threats with high precision.

160. The UN World Water Development Report 2026 was released by which organization?

- [A] United Nations Environment Programme
- [B] United Nations Children's Fund
- [C] United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- [D] World Health Organization

Answer: United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

The United Nations World Water Development Report 2026, released by UNESCO, highlights the strong link between gender inequality and water access. Globally, women and girls spend about 250 million hours daily fetching water, limiting their opportunities for education, employment, and rest. Around 2.1 billion people still lack safely managed drinking water, with women and girls bearing the greatest burden. In over 70% of unserved rural households, women and girls are primarily responsible for water collection, often from distant and unsafe sources.

161. What is the name of the scheme launched by the Ministry of Civil Aviation to provide fixed airfares?

- [A] Fare Se Fursat – One Route One Fare
- [B] Udaan Plus Scheme
- [C] Air Bharat Scheme
- [D] One Nation One Fare

Answer: Fare Se Fursat – One Route One Fare

Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu (Ministry of Civil Aviation – MoCA) and Mohan Yadav (Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh) launched the Fare Se Fursat – One Route One Fare Scheme on 18 March 2026 with the first Rewa–Raipur flight. The scheme aims to provide fixed and affordable airfares on selected regional routes, ensuring passengers pay the same ticket price regardless of booking time, making travel predictable and budget-friendly. It is implemented by Alliance Air, a government-owned regional airline, and currently covers six selected routes to promote regional connectivity.

162. According to recent report, which country accounted for the highest number of top methane-emitting oil and gas sites in 2025?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Russia
- [C] Turkmenistan
- [D] Venezuela

Answer: Turkmenistan

New research by University of California Los Angeles (UCLA) Stop Methane Project (SPM) using satellite data from Carbon Mapper found Turkmenistan has 15 of the top 25 methane-emitting oil and gas sites (2025), with 4,400+ methane plumes across 2,489 sites globally. Other major emission hotspots include Iran, Venezuela, Texas (USA) and Sindh (Pakistan), with emission rates ranging 3.7–10.5 tonnes/hour. In India, Ghazipur landfill in



Delhi is a major super-emitter, with a peak leak of 400 tonnes/hour (2022) due to anaerobic decomposition of organic waste.

163. South Shetland Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which region?

- [A] Antarctica
- [B] Europe
- [C] North America
- [D] South America

Answer: Antarctica

A magnitude 6.7 earthquake struck the South Shetland Islands in Antarctica, as reported by the German Research Centre for Geosciences (GFZ). The islands are a remote archipelago about 120 km north of the Antarctic Peninsula, discovered in 1819 by William Smith and often called the “jewel of Antarctica.” They were formed by volcanic activity, with some islands still active, especially Deception Island, known for its flooded caldera. More than 80% area is covered with permanent ice, and there are no permanent residents, though countries maintain seasonal research stations.

164. Which ministry is the nodal authority for Approved List of Models and Manufacturers Order (ALMM) Framework?

- [A] Ministry of Power
- [B] Ministry of Commerce
- [C] Ministry of Heavy Industries
- [D] Ministry of New and Renewable Energy

Answer: Ministry of New and Renewable Energy

Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) introduced ALMM List-III (for ingots and wafers), effective from 1 June 2028, under the Approved List of Models and Manufacturers Order 2019 (ALMM). ALMM is a quality and reliability framework ensuring solar equipment used in India meets domestic manufacturing standards. Ministry of New and Renewable Energy is the nodal authority for Approved List of Models and Manufacturers Order (ALMM) Framework. It has a tier structure: List-I (Solar PV Modules), List-II (Solar PV Cells) and List-III (Ingots and Wafers). Only approved models and manufacturers in ALMM can be used in government projects, schemes, net-metering and power sale to government.

165. Legionnaires’ disease, that was recently seen in news, is caused by which agent?

- [A] Bacteria
- [B] Virus
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Protozoa

Answer: Bacteria

Recent Legionnaires’ disease cases in London and New York have raised global concern. Public health experts warn that densely populated cities, including those in India, could face similar outbreaks if preventive measures are not strengthened. Legionnaires’ disease (LD) is a severe pneumonia caused by the bacterium *Legionella*, first identified in 1976 at an American Legion convention. Transmission occurs when people breathe in water or soil



containing *Legionella*; it is not contagious and generally cannot spread through drinking water unless aspirated. High-risk groups include older adults, smokers, and people with weakened immune systems.

166. Global Recycling Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] March 17
- [B] March 18
- [C] March 19
- [D] March 20

Answer: March 18

Global Recycling Day is observed annually on 18 March to promote recycling, conservation of natural resources, and environmental sustainability. 18 March 2026 marks the 9th observance, with the theme: "Don't Think Waste – Think Opportunity." It was established by the Bureau of International Recycling (BIR), founded on 18 March 1948, to promote recycling globally.

167. Which state/UT launched a mobile app called 'Blue Voice' to enhance safety and disaster preparedness for coastal fishing communities?

- [A] Puducherry
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Lakshadweep
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Puducherry

Pondicherry launched a mobile app called 'Blue Voice' to enhance safety and disaster preparedness for coastal fishing communities. The app provides real-time, location-specific weather updates in a user-friendly format, addressing language barriers and complex interfaces of conventional platforms. It allows fishers to share experiential knowledge alongside modern weather alerts, creating a participatory digital platform for better decision-making at sea.

168. What is the name of the portal launched by the Ministry of Ayush to track misleading advertisements and adverse drug reactions?

- [A] Ayush Mitra Portal
- [B] Ayush Suraksha Portal
- [C] Ayush Sathi Portal
- [D] Ayush Nivesh Portal

Answer: Ayush Suraksha Portal

Ministry of Ayush reported over 10,000 complaints registered on the Ayush Suraksha Portal since its launch on May 30, 2025. The portal tracks misleading and objectionable advertisements as well as adverse drug reactions related to Ayush products (Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha, Homoeopathy) and features a centralised dashboard for prompt regulatory action and data analysis. 10,269 complaints on misleading ads and 216 suspected adverse drug reactions; complaints forwarded to concerned authorities for action. Maharashtra recorded the highest number of complaints (approx 1,100), all



addressed; Madhya Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, and Delhi reported significant cases; repeat offenders identified and action taken.

169. International Day of Forests is observed annually on which day?

- [A] 20 March
- [B] 21 March
- [C] 22 March
- [D] 23 March

Answer: 21 March

International Day of Forests is observed annually on 21 March, proclaimed by the United Nations General Assembly in 2012, to raise awareness about the importance of forests. The theme for 2026 is “Forests and Economies”, highlighting the role of forests in livelihoods, income generation and economic sustainability. Forests are vital ecosystems that help in climate regulation, biodiversity conservation, and supporting communities. More than 1.6 billion people depend on forests for livelihood, and the sector provides 13 million formal jobs and 45–50 million informal jobs globally. Forests provide food, fuel, shelter and income, especially during economic shocks, conflicts and climate crises, but are often underrepresented in economic planning.

170. The Banana Cluster project has been announced in which district of Maharashtra?

- [A] Nashik
- [B] Jalgaon
- [C] Nagpur
- [D] Pune

Answer: Jalgaon

Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare announced a Banana Cluster project in Jalgaon, Maharashtra to improve production, storage and processing facilities. The project will develop planting material, pre-cooling units, cold chains and food processing, and promote Good Agricultural Practices (GAP), mechanisation and biocontrol. Financial support will be provided under Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH) and Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF). Jalgaon is known as the “Banana City of India”, contributing ~16% of national production, supported by black cotton soil, tropical climate and drip irrigation.

171. Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve (STR) is located in which state?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu Government sealed 42 illegal resorts in Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve (STR) to protect its eco-sensitive zone. Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve (STR) is the largest wildlife sanctuary in Tamil Nadu and part of the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve, acting as a vital corridor between the Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats. It is contiguous with Bandipur



Tiger Reserve, Mudumalai Tiger Reserve and BRT Tiger Reserve, and forms part of the Brahmagiri-Nilgiri-Eastern Ghats Elephant Reserve with a large Asian elephant population.

172. PM POSHAN is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [B] Ministry of Education
- [C] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Education

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education recommended adding breakfast under PM POSHAN to reduce undernourishment and stunting among children. The National Education Policy 2020 (NEP 2020) suggests nutritious breakfast before cognitively demanding morning classes to improve learning outcomes. Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Karnataka have already launched breakfast programmes using their own resources. PM POSHAN is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme under the Ministry of Education, replacing the Mid-Day Meal Scheme, and is implemented by the Department of School Education and Literacy. It provides one hot cooked meal daily to Classes 1–8 and Bal Vatikas in government and government-aided schools.

173. Who was conferred the Honorary Knight Commander of the Order of the British Empire (KBE) by the UK government in March 2026?

- [A] Natarajan Chandrasekaran
- [B] Sunil Bharti Mittal
- [C] Lakshmi Niwas Mittal
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Natarajan Chandrasekaran

Natarajan Chandrasekaran, Chairman of Tata Sons, was awarded the Honorary Knight Commander of the Order of the British Empire (KBE) by the United Kingdom (March 2026) for strengthening India–UK business relations. The honour was presented by Lindy Cameron, British High Commissioner to India, on behalf of King Charles III in New Delhi. An honorary knighthood for foreign nationals for exceptional contributions in business, public life, culture, and international relations; non-UK citizens use 'KBE' as a suffix (not 'Sir/Dame').

174. World Oral Health Day (WOHD) is observed annually on which day?

- [A] March 18
- [B] March 19
- [C] March 20
- [D] March 21

Answer: March 20

World Oral Health Day (WOHD) is observed annually on 20 March to promote oral hygiene awareness and reduce the burden of oral diseases. It was declared in 2007 (initially observed on 12 September), marking the birth anniversary of Dr. Charles Godon, founder of FDI World Dental Federation. The global campaign is led by the FDI World Dental



Federation, promoting awareness at individual, community, and policy levels.

175. World Water Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] March 21
- [B] March 22
- [C] March 23
- [D] March 24

Answer: March 22

World Water Day is observed annually on 22 March (since 1993) as a United Nations observance highlighting the importance of freshwater resources. The idea originated in 1992 at the United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (Rio de Janeiro), after which the UN officially designated the day. The day supports Sustainable Development Goal 6 (clean water and sanitation for all by 2030). The theme for 2026 is "Water and Gender", emphasizing the role of women and girls in water management. It raises awareness about water scarcity, pollution, and sanitation issues, encouraging global action for sustainable water use.

176. Sarhul festival is mainly celebrated in which state?

- [A] Jharkhand
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Jharkhand

Sarhul is a major Adivasi festival centred on nature worship, symbolising the union of the Sun and Earth and the renewal of life. The festival involves worship of the Sal tree, believed to be the abode of Sama Maa, and is celebrated by tribes like Oraon, Munda, Santal, Khadia and Ho. It is mainly observed in Jharkhand and parts of Odisha, West Bengal and Chhattisgarh. It is a three-day festival ending with a community feast, after which agricultural activities like sowing and ploughing begin, highlighting its link with livelihood and nature.

177. INS Taragiri (F41), that was recently seen in news, belongs to which class of warships?

- [A] Kolkata Class
- [B] Shivalik Class
- [C] Nilgiri Class
- [D] Talwar Class

Answer: Nilgiri Class

The Indian Navy is set to commission INS Taragiri (F41), a stealth frigate, on 03 April 2026. It is the fourth ship of the Nilgiri-class (Project 17A), built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilding Limited and designed by the Warship Design Bureau. The ship is a modern reincarnation of the earlier INS Taragiri (Leander-class frigate) and is built for high-speed, high-endurance, multi-dimensional naval operations.

178. What is the name of the scheme recently introduced by government to boost credit flow in the microfinance sector?



- [A] PM Mudra Yojana
- [B] Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs
- [C] Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0
- [D] Stand-Up India Scheme

Answer: Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0

The Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0 (CGSMFI-2.0) has been launched by the Government of India to boost credit flow in the microfinance sector. It provides guarantee cover through National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited (NCGTC) to banks and financial institutions for loans extended to NBFC-MFIs/MFIs for on-lending to small borrowers. Eligible borrowers include new and existing small borrowers as per Reserve Bank of India (RBI) microfinance norms. The scheme is expected to increase credit availability and benefit around 36 lakh small borrowers through enhanced on-lending.

179. National Productivity Council (NPC) functions under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [C] Ministry of Environment
- [D] Ministry of Labour

Answer: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

The National Productivity Council (NPC) has signed an agreement with the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) to act as the Environment Audit Designated Agency (EADA). National Productivity Council (NPC) was established as an autonomous, non-profit and multipartite organization under the Department for Promotion of Industry & Internal Trade, Ministry of Commerce and Industry, with headquarters in New Delhi. It aims to promote productivity awareness, strengthen economic development, act as a government think tank, and provide consultancy and training services.

180. A pilot plant for manufacturing Nd-Fe-B (Neodymium-Iron-Boron) rare earth permanent magnets has been established in which city?

- [A] Lucknow
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Mumbai
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: Hyderabad

A pilot plant for manufacturing Nd-Fe-B (Neodymium-Iron-Boron) rare earth permanent magnets has been established at International Advanced Research Centre for Powder Metallurgy and New Materials (ARCI), Hyderabad, under the Department of Science and Technology (DST). The facility adopts an end-to-end "mineral-to-market" approach, covering processes from strip-cast alloy production to finished sintered magnets, enabling a self-reliant manufacturing ecosystem. Nd-Fe-B magnets are critical components used in electric vehicles, renewable energy systems, electronics, and advanced manufacturing



technologies. The initiative aims to reduce import dependence, address global supply chain vulnerabilities, and strengthen India's position in the global rare earth value chain.

181. What is the IUCN conservation status of Shaheen Falcon that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Critically Endangered
- [B] Vulnerable
- [C] Least Concern
- [D] Endangered

Answer: Least Concern

A pair of Shaheen Falcon was recently found nesting in a multi-storey residential complex in Kochi, highlighting its adaptability to urban environments. The Shaheen Falcon (*Falco peregrinus peregrinator*) is a non-migratory subspecies of the Peregrine Falcon found mainly in the Indian subcontinent. It is found across India and also reported in the Andaman & Nicobar Islands. It is listed as Least Concern by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

182. Which state is the host of 49th Yonex Sunrise Junior National Badminton Championship 2026?

- [A] Manipur
- [B] Nagaland
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Assam

Answer: Sikkim

Sikkim has been selected as the host for the 49th Yonex Sunrise Junior National Badminton Championship 2026 (U-19, Individual & Team). The championship is scheduled to be held from 14th to 21st November 2026. The tournament is organised under the aegis of the Badminton Association of India (BAI). It will feature top junior badminton players from across India, competing at a national level.

183. Who is the author of the book "Karuna: The Power of Compassion"?

- [A] Kiran Bedi
- [B] Malala Yousafzai
- [C] Surya Kant
- [D] Kailash Satyarthi

Answer: Kailash Satyarthi

Kailash Satyarthi, Nobel Peace Prize laureate (2014), released his new book Karuna: The Power of Compassion in March 2026. The book was launched by the Satyarthi Movement for Global Compassion (SMGC) in association with HarperCollins India. The launch event was attended by Justice Surya Kant and Kiran Bedi. The book highlights compassion as a transformative force to address global challenges like inequality and conflict. It introduces the concept of Compassion Quotient (CQ) to measure and enhance compassion. Kailash Satyarthi won the Nobel Peace Prize 2014 along with Malala Yousafzai.

184. Litani River, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Egypt
- [B] Lebanon



[C] Israel

[D] Iran

Answer: Lebanon

Recently, Israeli airstrikes destroyed Qasmiyeh Bridge over Litani River in Lebanon's southern coastal highway. Litani River is the longest and major river of Lebanon. It originates west of Baalbek and flows southwest through Bekaa Valley between Lebanon and Anti-Lebanon mountains. It finally drains into the Mediterranean Sea.

185. World Meteorological Day is observed every year on which day?

[A] March 21

[B] March 22

[C] March 23

[D] March 24

Answer: March 23

World Meteorological Day is observed every year on March 23 to highlight the importance of weather, climate and water science. It commemorates the establishment of World Meteorological Organization (WMO – World Meteorological Organization) in 1950. The 2026 theme "Observing Today, Protecting Tomorrow" emphasizes accurate data and continuous monitoring. It promotes use of advanced technologies like satellites and radar for climate prediction and disaster management.

186. The book "Janjati Gaurav" has been published by which institute?

[A] Indian Council of Historical Research

[B] Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts

[C] Sahitya Akademi

[D] National Archives of India

Answer: Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts

Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA – Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts) published the book "Janjati Gaurav" to document tribal history and culture. The book highlights contributions of tribal communities in freedom struggle and nation-building. It includes archival records, research and stories of tribal leaders and movements. It mentions Mangarh Dham linked to uprising led by Govind Guru and sacrifices of tribal fighters. Ministry of Tribal Affairs approved 11 Tribal Freedom Fighters Museums across 10 states.

187. The Micro and Small Enterprises Cluster Development Programme (MSE-CDP) is implemented by which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

[B] Ministry of Micro Small and Medium Enterprises

[C] Ministry of Finance

[D] Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Micro Small and Medium Enterprises

Ministry of Micro Small and Medium Enterprises implements MSE-CDP (Micro and Small Enterprises Cluster Development Programme) to improve productivity and



competitiveness of MSEs (Micro and Small Enterprises). The scheme provides financial assistance to set up Common Facility Centres (CFCs) and upgrade infrastructure in industrial clusters. It is a demand-driven scheme with proposals from States and Union Territories based on needs. 242 CFCs have been approved across India including 6 in Punjab, while 513 clusters approved under SFURTI (Scheme of Fund for Regeneration of Traditional Industries) since 2015–16.

188. World Tuberculosis Day is observed annually on which day?

- [A] March 21
- [B] March 22
- [C] March 23
- [D] March 24

Answer: March 24

World Tuberculosis (TB) Day is observed every year on March 24. The date marks Dr. Robert Koch's discovery of Mycobacterium tuberculosis on March 24, 1882, which enabled TB diagnosis and treatment. In India, World TB Day is observed on March 24 to unite healthcare providers, governments, and communities against TB. The theme for 2026 is "Yes! We can end TB!" promoting hope and urgent action to combat the disease.

189. The Mulgao Kelbai Peth festival is celebrated in which state?

- [A] Bihar
- [B] Jharkhand
- [C] Goa
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Goa

The Mulgao Kelbai Peth festival is celebrated in Goa, specifically in the village of Mulgao located in the Bicholim taluka. The festival reflects deep-rooted cultural and religious traditions and attracts devotees from nearby regions. Goddess Kelbai is placed in a decorated wooden structure called "peth" and carried in a ceremonial procession. The event takes place on Chaitra Shuddha Panchami and is considered highly auspicious by local communities.

190. Recently, which institute successfully produced indigenous Sahiwal cattle calves using OPU-IVF-ET technology?

- [A] Indian Veterinary Research Institute
- [B] National Dairy Research Institute
- [C] Central Institute for Research on Cattle
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Indian Veterinary Research Institute

Indian Council of Agricultural Research-Indian Veterinary Research Institute produced Sahiwal calves using OPU-IVF-ET (Ovum Pick-Up-In Vitro Fertilization-Embryo Transfer). Sahiwal cattle is one of the best milk-producing indigenous breeds of India. It originates from Sahiwal region in Montgomery district of Punjab in Pakistan. It is also known as Lambi Bar, Lola, Montgomery, Multani and Teli. The cows are brownish-red in colour with



shades from mahogany to greyish red, while bulls have darker extremities.

191. Which State/UT government initiated a study with Indian Institute of Technology Madras on "smog-eating" photocatalytic coatings on roads?

- [A] Delhi
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Jammu and Kashmir
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Delhi

Delhi government and Indian Institute of Technology Madras are studying "smog-eating" photocatalytic road coatings to reduce air pollution. The coating neutralizes harmful gases like nitrogen dioxide and volatile hydrocarbons present in polluted air. It mainly uses Titanium dioxide which is low-cost, chemically stable and compatible with construction materials. Titanium dioxide-based materials help in gaseous depollution and environmental cleaning. Photocatalysis works by using light energy to break down harmful pollutants and organic waste into less toxic or harmless substances. This process helps improve air quality and contributes to cleaner environment.

192. The Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) in India is headed by whom?

- [A] Prime Minister
- [B] Home Minister
- [C] Defence Minister
- [D] Finance Minister

Answer: Prime Minister

Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) is chaired by the Prime Minister and handles key decisions on defence, expenditure and national security. It reviewed the global situation amid the West Asia conflict and assessed mitigation measures. The committee was first formed in 1947 by Jawaharlal Nehru after independence to address security challenges. Early members included Sardar Patel and Baldev Singh. After the 1999 Kargil War, CCS evolved into its present formal high-powered structure. Today, it is the apex decision-making body for internal and external security matters of the Government of India.

193. What is "Akasha300" that was recently seen in news?

- [A] High-temperature 3D printer
- [B] Satellite communication device
- [C] Laser cutting machine
- [D] CNC (Computer Numerical Control) milling machine

Answer: High-temperature 3D printer

A Kerala start-up has delivered the Akasha300 3D printer to Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), boosting India's self-reliance in advanced manufacturing. It is a high-temperature, multi-material extrusion 3D printer designed for industrial and research use. It is supported by the Space Technology Innovation and Incubation Centre at Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology (IIST) and Kerala Startup Mission. It uses dual-extrusion technology and can operate up to 350°C, with future upgrades to 500°C. It has a



modular design allowing multiple extrusion systems and hybrid manufacturing.

194. Which bank received the National Award for Outstanding Performance in Self-Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage 2024-25?

- [A] State Bank of India (SBI)
- [B] Karnataka Grameena Bank (KGB)
- [C] Canara Bank
- [D] Punjab National Bank (PNB)

Answer: Karnataka Grameena Bank (KGB)

Karnataka Grameena Bank received the National Award for Outstanding Performance in Self-Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage 2024-25 from the Union Ministry of Rural Development. The award recognises the bank's role in rural economic empowerment through SHGs. It was presented at the National Conference on Financial Literacy and Capacity Building and the 25th Central Level Coordination Committee meeting in Hyderabad. The merger under the 'One State - One Rural Bank' policy strengthened the bank's capacity for regional development. The bank aligns with Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM) to empower rural women through SHGs.

195. The SHE-Marts initiative has been launched under which scheme?

- [A] Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Rural Livelihoods Mission
- [B] Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)
- [C] National Urban Livelihoods Mission (NULM)
- [D] Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY)

Answer: Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Rural Livelihoods Mission

The Government has announced Self Help Entrepreneur (SHE) Marts to improve market access for women-led Self Help Group (SHG) enterprises. These marts will act as retail platforms where SHG products are directly sold to consumers. The aim is to strengthen market linkages, increase product visibility, and support women entrepreneurs. It will help women move from credit-based activities to full enterprise ownership. The initiative is under Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM). SHE-Marts will be community-owned outlets at cluster-level federations.

196. What is the name of the initiative under which multiple railway reforms were announced in 2026 to improve efficiency and service delivery?

- [A] Rail Vikas Abhiyan
- [B] Reform Express
- [C] Gati Shakti Rail Mission
- [D] Digital Rail India

Answer: Reform Express

Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw launched 5 new reforms under "Reform Express Initiative", taking total reforms in 2026 to 9. Reforms focus on cargo, infrastructure quality, and passenger convenience to improve efficiency of Indian Railways. A new container-based system for salt transport uses stainless steel containers with top-loading and



hydraulic discharge to reduce losses and damage. India produces approx 35 million tonnes of salt; 9.2 million tonnes move via rail, and this reform aims to increase rail share.

197. The GlobE Network was launched based on which initiative?

- [A] Paris Climate Agreement
- [B] Beijing Declaration
- [C] Riyadh Initiative
- [D] Geneva Convention

Answer: Riyadh Initiative

India hosted the 12th Steering Committee Meeting of the GlobE Network. It was established in 2021 based on the Riyadh Initiative during G20 Saudi Arabia Presidency 2020. It is a global platform for anti-corruption law enforcement agencies. Its aim is to strengthen international cooperation to detect, investigate, and prosecute corruption cases. Membership is open to UN Member States and parties to United Nations Convention against Corruption. India is represented by Central Bureau of Investigation and Directorate of Enforcement.

198. Which of the following books analyses "Operation Sindoor" and India's new counter-terror doctrine?

- [A] India's Security Doctrine
- [B] Red Lines Redrawn: Operation Sindoor and India's New Normal
- [C] Strategic Frontiers of India
- [D] India's Defence Vision 2030

Answer: Red Lines Redrawn: Operation Sindoor and India's New Normal

The book Red Lines Redrawn: Operation Sindoor and India's New Normal was released by Upendra Dwivedi in 2026. It is authored by experts including Bipin Bakshi, Rajesh Kumar, Anil Trigunayat, and Akhelesh Bhargava. The book analyses the 88-hour Operation Sindoor, highlighting India's response to Pakistan-sponsored terrorism. It explains India's shift from reactive to proactive counter-terror strategy, especially in Kashmir. It covers multi-domain operations including military, intelligence, drones, cyber, and diplomacy.

199. Which state has become second in India after Uttarakhand to adopt Uniform Civil Code (UCC)?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Gujarat

Gujarat Assembly passed the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill on 24 March 2026 after long debate. The bill was introduced by Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel based on a state panel report. Gujarat became the second state after Uttarakhand (2024) to adopt UCC. It creates a common law for marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships for all religions. It makes registration of live-in relationships mandatory and defines their termination rules. It prohibits bigamy, allowing marriage only if no spouse is living. It applies to Gujarat residents, including those living outside the state. It excludes Scheduled Tribes



(STs) and groups with protected customary rights.

200. The National Biodiversity Authority was established under which Act?

[A] Environment Protection Act, 1986

[B] Wildlife Protection Act, 1972

[C] Biological Diversity Act, 2002

[D] Forest Conservation Act, 1980

Answer: Biological Diversity Act, 2002

National Biodiversity Authority launched a short-term internship programme (up to 3 months) for graduate and postgraduate students. NBA is a statutory body under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002, established in 2003. Its headquarters is in Chennai. It performs facilitative, regulatory, and advisory roles for biodiversity conservation and sustainable use. It ensures fair and equitable sharing of benefits from biological resources.

201. Great Salt Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

[A] United States

[B] United Kingdom

[C] France

[D] Australia

Answer: United States

Researchers at the University of Utah discovered that freshwater saturates the rock and sediment beneath the Great Salt Lake to depths of up to 13,000 feet. The Great Salt Lake is a saline, endorheic lake located in northern Utah, United States, and it is the largest inland saltwater body in the Western Hemisphere. It is fed by the Bear River, Weber River, and Jordan River, but has no outlet, so water leaves primarily through evaporation. The lake's salinity is higher than that of the oceans due to high evaporation rates and limited inflow, and it exists in an arid environment similar to the Dead Sea.

202. The 'Districts as Export Hubs Initiative' is implemented by which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Finance

[B] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

[C] Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises

[D] Ministry of External Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

The Minister of State for Commerce & Industry informed the Lok Sabha about the Districts as Export Hubs (DEH) Initiative, launched in August 2019 to promote balanced regional development across all districts of India. The initiative aims to identify, brand, and promote products from each district, facilitating their sale in domestic and international markets. The 'Districts as Export Hubs Initiative' is implemented by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. It is run by the Department of Commerce (DoC) through the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) in partnership with the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), focusing on increasing exports from every district.



203. What is the primary purpose of the PRISM-SG Portal?

- [A] To manage railway ticket bookings
- [B] To approve highway toll rates
- [C] To monitor road traffic violations
- [D] To digitize approval and inspection processes for Road Over Bridges (ROBs)

Answer: To digitize approval and inspection processes for Road Over Bridges (ROBs)

The PRISM-SG (Portal for Rail-Road Inspection & Stages Management – Steel Girders) Portal was launched by Minister for Road Transport and Highways, Shri Nitin Gadkari, Railways, Information & Broadcasting, Electronics & IT, Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw, to digitise approvals and inspections for Road Over Bridges (ROBs). The portal covers Quality Assurance Plans (QAP), Welding Procedure Specification Sheets (WPSS), and fabrication stage inspections of steel girders, enabling end-to-end online submission, scrutiny, approvals, inspections, and real-time monitoring.

204. The Shakti Sadan Scheme was formed by merging which two schemes?

- [A] Beti Bachao Beti Padhao and Ujjawala
- [B] Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala
- [C] Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala
- [D] Ujjawala and Nirbhaya

Answer: Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala

Under Mission Shakti, the schemes Swadhar Greh (home for women in difficult circumstances) and Ujjawala (home for women rescued from trafficking) were merged on 01.04.2022 into Shakti Sadan Scheme. Shakti Sadan is an integrated relief and rehabilitation home for women in distress, including trafficked women. It provides shelter, support, and rehabilitation to help women overcome adverse circumstances. It is a demand-driven Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS) with funds released to States/Union Territories (UTs) based on local needs. Currently, 419 Shakti Sadans operate nationwide, rehabilitating about 19,960 women in FY 2025-26 (01.04.2025–31.12.2025).

205. Vayu Baan is India's first helicopter-launched drone system developed by which organization?

- [A] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- [B] Indian Air Force (IAF)
- [C] Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Indian Air Force (IAF)

Vayu Baan is India's first helicopter-launched drone system developed by the Indian Air Force (IAF). It is a small, autonomous drone dropped from a moving helicopter mid-flight. After release, it unfolds wings, activates propulsion, and functions as surveillance (ISR) or precision-guided munition (kamikaze drone). The program is an indigenous Air-Launched Effects (ALE) project led by IAF's Directorate of Aerospace Design (DAD). It aims to provide stand-off capability to identify and destroy targets beyond 50 km, keeping helicopters safe from MANPADS.

206. Which ministry has launched the PAIMANA portal for monitoring major infrastructure



projects?

- [A] Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- [B] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Ministry of MSME

Answer: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

The Centre is monitoring 1,948 infrastructure projects worth ₹41.98 lakh crore through the PAIMANA portal, with nearly 47% of total revised cost spent. As of February 2026, cumulative expenditure is ₹19.71 lakh crore (46.95%), indicating steady progress across ministries. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) launched the PAIMANA portal for monitoring major infrastructure projects. PAIMANA stands for Project Assessment, Infrastructure Monitoring and Analytics for Nation-building.

207. Where was International Academic Conference on Ekatma Manav Darshan – Bharat's Worldview held in March 2026?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Karnataka

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan virtually inaugurated the International Academic Conference on Ekatma Manav Darshan – Bharat's Worldview at Karnataka State Open University. The event marks 60 years of Ekatma Manav Darshan (Integral Humanism), a philosophy given by Deendayal Upadhyaya. Integral Humanism focuses on balanced development of individual, society, and nature in harmony.

208. Which state government launched Nivesh Mitra 3.0, a digital platform to simplify and improve investor experience?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Bihar
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched Nivesh Mitra 3.0, a digital platform to simplify and improve investor experience. More than 85 Letters of Comfort (LoCs), Eligibility Certificates (ECs) and ₹2,781 crore subsidies were distributed to support investments. Nivesh Mitra 3.0 features an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based chatbot for instant help and real-time SMS alerts for application tracking. It includes a Dynamic Combined Application Form (CAF) enabling single-window clearance from multiple departments. This reduces the need to visit different offices, saving time and effort for investors.

209. Who is the author of the book "Revolutionary Raj: Narendra Modi's 25 Years"?

- [A] Rajdeep Sardesai



[B] Shekhar Gupta

[C] Prannoy Roy

[D] Alok Mehta

Answer: Alok Mehta

"Revolutionary Raj: Narendra Modi's 25 Years," authored by veteran journalist Padma Shri Alok Mehta, is a coffee table book launched in 2026 analyzing PM Modi's political journey from Gujarat CM to Prime Minister. The book highlights his transformative governance, administrative innovations, and key welfare initiatives. It covers Modi's 25 years in public life, discussing his policies, ideology, and impact on Indian society and the global stage.

210. The Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) is conducted by which organization?

[A] NITI Aayog

[B] National Statistical Office (NSO)

[C] Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

[D] Central Statistics Commission

Answer: National Statistical Office (NSO)

Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) 2025 results released for January–December 2025 period. It is conducted by National Statistical Office (NSO) under Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI). The purpose is to provide inputs for Gross Domestic Product (GDP) estimation and National Accounts. It covers unincorporated non-agricultural sector, including manufacturing, trade, and services. Tracks key indicators like employment, Gross Value Added (GVA), wages, and digital usage. It helps in understanding the informal economy and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) sector.

211. What is the rank of India in the Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) 2025?

[A] 88th

[B] 89th

[C] 91st

[D] 95th

Answer: 91st

The Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) 2025 by Transparency International shows global corruption worsening, with the average score falling to 42/100 and 122 of 182 countries below 50. Only five countries score above 80, compared with 12 a decade ago, showing a clear global decline in governance perceptions. India scores 39, ranking 91 out of 182 countries, remaining in the lower half; the score has fluctuated between 38–41 over the past decade. Despite being the world's fourth-largest economy, India's governance perception has not matched its economic growth.

212. The QS World University Rankings are published by which organization?

[A] Times Higher Education

[B] UNESCO

[C] Quacquarelli Symonds



[D] World Bank

Answer: Quacquarelli Symonds

Indian Institute of Management Kozhikode (IIM-K) entered the Top 100 in QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026 for the first time, marking a major global achievement. QS World University Rankings are published annually by Quacquarelli Symonds (QS), a global higher education consultancy. Rankings assess universities using parameters like academic reputation, employer reputation, and employment outcomes. IIT (ISM) Dhanbad and IIM Ahmedabad achieved India's highest rank (21) globally.

213. Amrabad Tiger Reserve is located in which state?

[A] Karnataka

[B] Maharashtra

[C] Telangana

[D] Gujarat

Answer: Telangana

Telangana Government has started rehabilitation and relocation of tribal families from Amrabad Tiger Reserve (ATR) to balance tribal development and wildlife conservation. Amrabad Tiger Reserve is located in the Nallamala Hills of Eastern Ghats in Telangana. It was earlier part of Nagarjunasagar-Srisailem Tiger Reserve before Andhra Pradesh-Telangana bifurcation (2014). The reserve has rugged terrain, deep valleys, and dense forests, supporting rich biodiversity. Krishna River and its streams flow through the reserve, feeding Srisailem Dam and Nagarjunasagar Dam. The Chenchu tribe, a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG), is the main community residing inside the reserve.

214. Which state government has launched Industrial Park Promotion Policy-2026 to boost jobs, investment?

[A] Rajasthan

[B] Bihar

[C] Jharkhand

[D] Punjab

Answer: Rajasthan

Rajasthan Government launched Industrial Park Promotion Policy-2026 under CM Bhajanlal Sharma to boost investment, infrastructure, and employment. It aims to develop world-class industrial parks and make Rajasthan a future-ready industrial hub. Policy aligns with Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat, promoting balanced regional development. Industrial parks will be developed through four models: private, hybrid land-sharing, and Public-Private Partnership (PPP) modes.

215. What is the name of the operation launched by the Indian Navy to protect India-bound energy shipments?

[A] Operation Samudra Raksha

[B] Operation Urja Suraksha

[C] Operation Sagar Kavach



[D] Operation Jal Suraksha

Answer: Operation Urja Suraksha

The Indian Navy has launched Operation Urja Suraksha to safeguard India-bound energy shipments in the Strait of Hormuz amid rising West Asia tensions. The operation is conducted carefully and discreetly to ensure safe transit of Indian-flagged cargo vessels carrying critical energy supplies. A total of 22 vessels have been identified for secure transit, including 20 high-priority ships carrying LNG, LPG, and crude oil.

216. KAVACH system has been developed by which organization?

[A] Defence Research and Development Organisation

[B] Indian Space Research Organisation

[C] Research Designs and Standards Organization

[D] Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited

Answer: Research Designs and Standards Organization

Indian Railways has approved the extension of the KAVACH system across multiple railway zones to enhance train safety and operational efficiency. KAVACH is an indigenous Train Collision Avoidance System (TCAS) designed to prevent train accidents by automatically applying brakes when two trains are on a collision course. It has been developed by the Research Designs & Standards Organization (RDSO) under Indian Railways. It provides continuous real-time updates to the locomotive, ensuring better monitoring and control.

217. Qader is a medium-range, shore-based anti-ship cruise missile developed by which country?

[A] Iran

[B] Israel

[C] Iraq

[D] Pakistan

Answer: Iran

Iran reportedly fired Qader cruise missiles targeting the USS Abraham Lincoln aircraft carrier, though reports indicate the ship was not hit. Qader is a medium-range, shore-based anti-ship cruise missile developed by Iran. It is an upgraded version of the Noor missile, which itself is based on the Chinese C-802 design. The missile strengthens Iran's coastal defence and anti-access/area denial (A2/AD) capabilities in strategic regions like the Strait of Hormuz. It is part of Iran's broader strategy to deter naval forces and protect its maritime interests.

218. Agnite is the world's largest single-piece 3D-printed booster engine developed by which organization?

[A] Indian Space Research Organisation

[B] Defence Research and Development Organisation

[C] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited

[D] Agnikul Cosmos

Answer: Agnikul Cosmos

Agnikul Cosmos has achieved a major milestone by successfully test-firing the Agnite Engine, marking progress in India's private space sector. Agnite is the world's largest



single-piece 3D-printed booster engine, showcasing advanced additive manufacturing technology. It is part of a family of engines including Agnite and Agnilet, which are 3D-printed semi-cryogenic engines developed by Agnikul. These engines are specifically built to power the booster stage of Agnikul's Agnibaan launch vehicle.

219. CALM-Brain, India's first digital brain repository, was launched in which city?

- [A] Bengaluru
- [B] Hyderabad
- [C] Chennai
- [D] New Delhi

Answer: Bengaluru

CALM-Brain has been launched in Bengaluru as India's first digital repository focused on brain structure and psychiatric disorders. It has been developed by researchers at the Rohini Nilekani Centre for Brain and Mind, which is a collaboration between NIMHANS (National Institute of Mental Health and Neurosciences) and NCBS (National Centre for Biological Sciences). The repository is built using data collected from Indian patients, making it highly relevant for understanding mental health conditions in the Indian population. It aims to support research in neuroscience and psychiatry, enabling better diagnosis, treatment, and understanding of brain disorders.

220. What is the name of regional connectivity scheme launched to make air travel affordable in India?

- [A] UDAN Scheme
- [B] BharatNet Scheme
- [C] Sagarmala Programme
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: UDAN Scheme

The Union Cabinet has approved a modified version of the UDAN Scheme with a total outlay of ₹28,840 crore. The scheme will be implemented over a 10-year period from FY 2026–27 to FY 2035–36, ensuring long-term support for regional air connectivity. UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik) is a regional connectivity scheme launched in 2016 to make air travel affordable and accessible to the common citizen. The scheme focuses on connecting unserved and underserved airports across India through subsidised fares and financial incentives.

221. The "Nasha Mukh Vidyalaya" action plan has been launched by which ministries?

- [A] Ministry of Education and Ministry of Home Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment and Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [C] Ministry of Education and Ministry of Social Justice
- [D] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Education and Ministry of Home Affairs

In March 2026, the Ministry of Education, in collaboration with the Ministry of Home Affairs, has launched a comprehensive 3-Year Action Plan for "Nasha Mukh Vidyalaya" (Drug-Free Schools) under the broader Nasha Mukh Bharat Abhiyan. A central provision of



the plan is to formally declare the area within a 500-metre radius of all schools (government and private) as drug-free zones. The action plan provides a structured approach for the next three years to eliminate substance use in educational environments.

222. The “True Cyber Sakhi” initiative has been launched by which organization?

- [A] National Human Rights Commission
- [B] National Commission for Women
- [C] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- [D] National Commission for Protection of Child Rights

Answer: National Commission for Women

The National Commission for Women (NCW) has launched “True Cyber Sakhi”, a digital safety toolkit aimed at empowering women in the online space. The initiative focuses on enhancing awareness, resilience, and protection against cyber threats and online harassment. It is designed to educate women about safe internet practices, including identifying cyber fraud, phishing, and digital abuse. The toolkit promotes digital literacy and self-protection skills, enabling women to navigate the online world confidently and securely.

223. Where was the 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14) of the World Trade Organization (WTO) held?

- [A] Mexico
- [B] France
- [C] Chile
- [D] Cameroon

Answer: Cameroon

The 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14) of the World Trade Organization (WTO) is held from 26–29 March 2026 in Yaoundé, Cameroon. The conference brings together trade ministers from WTO member countries to discuss key global trade issues. The Indian delegation is led by Piyush Goyal, along with officials, experts, and representatives from multiple ministries.

224. Who is the author of book "The Doom Loop"?

- [A] Esar Prasad
- [B] Shashi Tharoor
- [C] Nitin Gadkari
- [D] Vikrant Sinha

Answer: Esar Prasad

In 2026, the book *The Doom Loop* was released, authored by Eswar Prasad, which analyzes the growing disorder in the global economic system. The book highlights a “doom loop”, where interconnected global forces reinforce instability, making it harder to restore economic balance and global cooperation.

225. Shaurya Squadrons recently inducted by the Indian Army are primarily associated with which type of regiment?



- [A] Infantry regiments
- [B] Armoured regiments
- [C] Artillery regiments
- [D] Engineer regiments

Answer: Armoured regiments

The Indian Army has started fielding Shaurya Squadrons, which are dedicated drone sub-units within armoured regiments. Shaurya Squadrons provide tank commanders with real-time surveillance and precision-strike capability at the unit level. Each squadron has 20 to 30 personnel trained in drone and counter-drone operations. They operate surveillance drones, attack drones, swarm drones, first-person view (FPV) drones, and loitering munitions.

226. Lyme disease, that was recently seen in news, is caused by which agent?

- [A] Virus
- [B] Bacteria
- [C] Fungus
- [D] Protozoa

Answer: Bacteria

U.S. drugmaker Pfizer and France's Valneva reported that their experimental Lyme disease vaccine showed over 70% efficacy in a late-stage trial. Lyme disease, or Lyme borreliosis, is caused by the bacteria *Borrelia burgdorferi*. It affects the skin, nervous system, heart, and joints. The disease is named after Lyme, Connecticut, United States, where it was first identified in children in 1976. Lyme disease is common in North America, Europe, and parts of Asia. It is transmitted to humans through deer ticks (black-legged ticks) found in grassy, wooded, or bushy areas. Not all tick bites cause Lyme disease, and it cannot spread between humans or from pets.

227. Which state has become the twelfth to sign a Reform-Linked Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Tripura
- [C] Manipur
- [D] Meghalaya

Answer: Meghalaya

Meghalaya has become the twelfth State to sign a Reform-Linked Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0, marking its entry into the reform-linked implementation framework approved on March 10, 2026. It was launched to promote outcome-oriented rural water supply, JJM 2.0 emphasizes decentralization, community ownership, and sustainable services managed by Gram Panchayats and Village Water & Sanitation Committees (VWSCs). Meghalaya has achieved 83% rural tap water coverage under JJM and aims for 100% coverage through accelerated implementation aligned with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision.

228. What is the primary objective of Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj Initiative (MGGSII)?



- [A] Develop urban infrastructure
- [B] Build rural self-reliance in khadi, handloom, and handicrafts
- [C] Provide subsidies to farmers
- [D] Promote Information Technology (IT) startups in rural areas

Answer: Build rural self-reliance in khadi, handloom, and handicrafts

The Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj Initiative (MGGSI) aims to build rural self-reliance in khadi, handloom, and handicrafts and to promote employment-oriented growth through development of scalable, export-oriented rural enterprises. It supports local weavers, artisans, and rural youth by creating backward and forward linkages across value chains and aligns with the One District One Product (ODOP) initiative. The Office of the Development Commissioner (Handicrafts) implements the National Handicrafts Development Programme (NHDP) and Comprehensive Handicrafts Cluster Development Scheme (CHCDS), providing skill development, marketing, cluster development, infrastructure, and technology support to artisans.

229. Which country is the host of G7 Summit 2026?

- [A] France
- [B] Germany
- [C] Japan
- [D] Italy

Answer: France

Narendra Modi will attend the G7 Summit 2026, scheduled from June 15–17, 2026 in France, following confirmation after discussions with S. Jaishankar. The G7 comprises major economies such as the US, UK, Japan, France, Germany, Italy, and Canada, focusing on global economic stability, security, climate change, and trade. Although India is not a G7 member, its participation reflects its growing global influence. India plays an important role in bridging developed and developing countries and contributes to discussions on inclusive and balanced global governance.

230. Who was honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the International Film Festival of Delhi 2026?

- [A] Trivikram Srinivas
- [B] Koratala Siva
- [C] Nandamuri Balakrishna
- [D] Anil Ravipudi

Answer: Nandamuri Balakrishna

Nandamuri Balakrishna was honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the International Film Festival of Delhi 2026 on March 26, 2026, held at Bharat Mandapam. The award recognises his five-decade-long contribution to Indian cinema, especially his impact on Telugu film industry. Known for his versatility, he has delivered performances in both commercial and character-driven roles, becoming an iconic figure. A key highlight of the event was the screening of his film Bhagavanth Kesari, directed by Anil Ravipudi.

231. The S-400 is a modern long-range surface-to-air missile (MLR SAM) system developed by



which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] France
- [C] Russia
- [D] Japan

Answer: Russia

India is set to receive the remaining two units of the S-400 Triumf from Russia in 2026, completing the delivery under the deal. The system was procured under a \$5.43 billion agreement signed in 2018 for five squadrons, out of which three are already inducted into the Indian Air Force. The S-400 is a modern long-range surface-to-air missile (MLR SAM) system developed by Russia. It can track and destroy multiple aerial targets at once within a range of up to 600 kilometres. The S-400 provides a powerful multi-layered air defence shield against threats like fighter jets, drones, cruise missiles, ballistic missiles, and stealth aircraft.

232. *Nyctibatrachus kali*, that was recently seen in news, belongs to which species?

- [A] Ant
- [B] Snake
- [C] Spider
- [D] Frog

Answer: Frog

A new frog species named *Nyctibatrachus kali* (Kali Night Frog) has been discovered. It is found in Kali Tiger Reserve. The name comes from the nearby Kali River, after which the reserve is also named. It is a cryptic species, meaning it looks very similar to other frogs. It resembles the Kumbara Night Frog (*Nyctibatrachus kumbara*) discovered in 2014. Its sound is unique and similar to wood-chopping noise in forests. Kali Tiger Reserve is located in Uttara Kannada district of Karnataka.

233. Earth Hour is organized globally by which organization?

- [A] United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
- [B] Greenpeace International
- [C] World Wildlife Fund (WWF)
- [D] International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)

Answer: World Wildlife Fund (WWF)

Earth Hour is a global grassroots movement to protect the environment and fight climate change. It is organized by World Wildlife Fund (WWF - World Wildlife Fund). In India, awareness activities were held with Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC - Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change). It started in Sydney in 2007 as a lights-off event. It is held at the end of March every year.

234. Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council (BRIC) works under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- [B] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [C] Ministry of Education



[D] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer: Ministry of Science and Technology

Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council (BRIC) held its first Research Advisory Board meeting at Regional Centre for Biotechnology. BRIC is an apex autonomous body registered as a society. It was formed by merging 14 institutes of DBT (Department of Biotechnology). It provides centralized governance and funding through intra-mural core grants. It aims to build future scientific leaders and innovation ecosystem. It promotes cutting-edge biotech research aligned with national priorities. It works under Ministry of Science and Technology.

235. Where was IMEX TTX 2026 (IONS Maritime Exercise Tabletop Exercise 2026) held?

[A] Surat

[B] Jaipur

[C] Kochi

[D] Bhopal

Answer: Kochi

Indian Navy hosted IMEX TTX 2026 (IONS Maritime Exercise Tabletop Exercise 2026) at Maritime Warfare Centre, Southern Naval Command, Kochi. It involved members of Indian Ocean Naval Symposium and international officers to discuss maritime security. Countries like Bangladesh, France, Indonesia, Kenya, Maldives, Mauritius, Myanmar, Seychelles, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Tanzania, and Timor-Leste participated. India assumes IONS Chairmanship (2026–2028) after 16 years.

236. Which ministry released PLFS (Periodic Labour Force Survey) report 2025?

[A] Ministry of Labour and Employment

[B] Ministry of Finance

[C] Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

[D] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI - Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation) released PLFS 2025 report. PLFS (Periodic Labour Force Survey) was started in 2017 by National Statistical Office (NSO - National Statistical Office) to track jobs and unemployment. It provides data as Usual Status (365 days) and Current Weekly Status (7 days). LFPR (Labour Force Participation Rate) remained stable at 59.3% (Male 79.1%, Female 40%). WPR (Worker Population Ratio) was 57.4%, with rural female participation steady. UR (Unemployment Rate) declined to 3.1%, youth unemployment fell to 9.9%.

237. Zojila Pass, that was recently seen in news, lies in which mountain range?

[A] Pir Panjal Range

[B] Shivalik Range

[C] Karakoram Range

[D] Greater Himalayan Range

Answer: Greater Himalayan Range



A massive avalanche occurred at Zojila Pass, a key high-altitude pass. It is called the “Mountain Pass of Blizzards” and lies on Srinagar–Kargil–Leh highway (NH-1) in the Greater Himalayas. An avalanche is a sudden movement of a large mass of snow down a slope. It is dangerous as it can bury or sweep away everything in its path. Avalanches are more likely on steep slopes without trees or rocks. These natural barriers usually help in holding snow in place.

238. The Shakti Sadan Scheme was formed by merging which two schemes?

- [A] One Stop Centre and Mahila Police Volunteers
- [B] Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala
- [C] Beti Bachao Beti Padhao and Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana
- [D] Mahila Police Volunteers and Nari Shakti Puraskar

Answer: Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala

Shakti Sadan Scheme aims to provide a safe and supportive environment for women in distress. It was launched in 2022 under Mission Shakti by merging Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala schemes. The objective is to offer shelter and rehabilitation support to women in difficult circumstances. It is a Centrally Sponsored and demand-driven scheme implemented by States and Union Territories. It provides services like safe shelter, food, healthcare, legal aid, counselling, and rehabilitation. The scheme is monitored through field visits, review meetings, and Mission Shakti Dashboard. It focuses on protection, empowerment, and reintegration of vulnerable women into society.

239. The upgraded Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP) was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [B] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- [C] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [D] Ministry of Defence

Answer: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW - Ministry of Health and Family Welfare) launched upgraded IDSP (Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme). IDSP (Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme) started in 2004 under NHM (National Health Mission), tracks infectious diseases and outbreaks. The upgrade focuses on early detection and real-time surveillance of bio-threats. It now covers bio-emergencies, bio-warfare, and bio-terrorism preparedness.

240. The Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises (PMFME) Scheme was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- [B] Ministry of Food Processing Industries
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Answer: Ministry of Food Processing Industries

Under PMFME (Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises), over



1.72 lakh loans sanctioned till Dec 2025. It was launched in 2020 by Ministry of Food Processing Industries as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme. The objective is to formalise and upgrade micro food processing units. It supports FPOs (Farmer Producer Organisations), SHGs (Self Help Groups), cooperatives, and entrepreneurs.

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